



CITY: PG 3

PM to inaugurate, lay foundation of projects worth Rs 33,500 crore



NATION: PG 5

Rahul: Politics, int'l relations now moving towards 'darkness'



FILM: PG 12

Priyanka Chopra Jonas to present award at 98th Oscars

— ISRAEL POUNDS | IRAN HITS BACK | TRUMP DEMANDS IRAN'S 'UNCONDITIONAL SURRENDER' —

Day 7: War shows no let-up

Gulf allies complain US didn't notify them of Iran attacks & ignored their warnings

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: Israeli warplanes pounded Beirut and Tehran on Friday as Iran launched another wave of retaliatory strikes against Israel and Gulf countries. There was no sign of the war letting up on its seventh day, as US President Donald Trump appeared to rule out negotiations with Iran and called for its "unconditional surrender."

Trump demanded Iran's "unconditional surrender" as the only acceptable outcome to end hostilities, while promising to help rebuild the country's economy if Tehran compiled and installed new leadership.

"There will be no deal with Iran except UNCONDITIONAL SURRENDER," Trump wrote on his Truth Social platform.

The post came as Israel bombed regime targets in Tehran and Hezbollah positions in Beirut, and Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth said US strikes against Iran were "about to surge dramatically."

Trump said that following any capitulation by the Islamic Republic, the United States and its allies would work to bring Iran "back from the brink of destruction, making it economically bigger, better, and stronger than ever before."

He closed with a new slo-



Smoke rises following an Israeli airstrike in Dahiyeh, Beirut's southern suburbs, in Beirut, Lebanon, Friday

gan — "MAKE IRAN GREAT AGAIN (MIGA!)" — a riff on his "Make America Great Again" political brand.

Israeli fighter jets carried out a major strike in the heart of Tehran early on Friday, targeting an underground bunker built beneath the leadership compound of Iran's supreme leader.

The Israeli Air Force said approximately 50 jets took part in the operation, guided by precise intelligence from Israel's Military Intelligence and

coordinated with Mossad. The target was the underground bunker constructed for Ayatollah Ali Khamenei.

The Israeli military described the bunker as serving as "a secure emergency asset" intended for Khamenei to manage fighting during a conflict. It was never used by Khamenei because he had already been eliminated in earlier strikes during Operation "Roaring Lion". After his death, the compound continued to be used by other senior officials of

Rising tensions

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» The Israeli Air Force said approximately 50 jets took part in the operation, guided by precise intelligence from Israel's Military Intelligence and coordinated with Mossad

» Iran meanwhile launched missile and drone attacks at Israel, as well as Kuwait, Qatar, Saudi Arabia and Bahrain, all countries that host US forces

» The war has killed at least 1,230 people in Iran, more than 120 in Lebanon and around a dozen in Israel. Six US troops have been killed

the Iranian regime.

The war has escalated to affect more than a dozen countries across the Middle East and beyond. The US said it had struck an Iranian drone carrier at sea as it waged an unrelenting campaign against the country's navy that earlier included torpedoing of a warship in the Indian Ocean.

The US and Israel have battered Iran with strikes, targeting their military capabilities, leadership and nuclear program. Continued on P4

Claim on Navy intel 'baseless': Sources

NEW DELHI: Top government sources on Friday described as "baseless and preposterous" claims that the Indian Navy provided intelligence to the US on an Iranian frigate that was sunk by a US military submarine two days ago off the coast of Sri Lanka.

There is no question of providing any input to the US and the claims are completely baseless, the sources said.

The US sank the Iranian warship IRIS Dena off the coast of Sri Lanka on Wednesday when it was returning home after participating in the Milan multilateral naval exercise hosted by India.

At least 87 Iranian sailors were killed in the attack, Continued on P4

News channel TRPs put on hold

NEW DELHI: The government on Friday directed television rating agency BARC to immediately withhold reporting the Television Rating Points (TRPs) for TV news channels for a period of four weeks or until further orders.

The directive has been issued as certain TV news channels are displaying "unwarranted sensationalism and speculative content" about the ongoing Israel-Iran conflict, which "may potentially create panic" among the general public, specially those having friends and family in the affected areas or residing in the conflict zones.

According to the 'Policy Guidelines' Continued on P4

Indian refiners eye Russian oil cargoes



US grants temporary waiver

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Indian refiners have begun buying some of the over 15 million barrels of Russian crude currently floating on tankers near the country, as they move to offset supply concerns arising from disruptions in the Middle East.

Sources said refiners stepped up purchases after the US Treasury Department issued a 30-day licence allowing India to buy Russian oil cargoes currently stuck at sea.

India, which was among the top buyers of Russian oil, curtailed purchases after the US pressured New Delhi to avoid buying Russian barrels in an effort to reduce money flowing to Moscow's war effort in Ukraine

KEY POINTS

» Sources said refiners stepped up purchases after the US Treasury Department issued a 30-day licence allowing India to buy Russian oil cargoes currently stuck at sea

» India, which was among the top buyers of Russian oil, curtailed purchases after US pressured New Delhi to avoid buying Russian barrels in an effort to reduce money flowing to Moscow's war effort in Ukraine

» India's imports of Russian crude in February fell to 1.04 million barrels per day - the lowest since November 2022

Government invokes ESMA powers

NEW DELHI: The government invoked sparingly used emergency powers to direct oil refineries to ramp up LPG production as it looks to increase the availability of domestic cooking gas to hedge against potential disruptions from the widening Middle East conflict. See P9

ASSAM JET TRAGEDY

Su-30MKI crash: IAF loses two air warriors

NEW DELHI: Two pilots of the Indian Air Force (IAF) were killed in a crash of a Su-30 MKI multi-role fighter jet in Assam's Karbi Anglong district.

The IAF confirmed on Friday the deaths of Squadron Leader Anuj and Flight Lieutenant Purvesh Duragkar, a day after the Russian-origin aircraft went missing.

The jet was on a training sortie and disappeared from radar shortly after taking off from Jorhat airbase on Thursday.

The IAF headquarters ordered a court of inquiry into the crash. See P4

Delhi's new L-G Sandhu vows dedicated service

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The newly appointed Delhi Lt Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Friday said he is committed to serving the people of Delhi and the nation with dedication and humility.



President Droupadi Murmu appointed the former diplomat as the Delhi L-G, replacing VK Saxena who had been in office for nearly four years.

Continued on P4

AP BANS U-13, K'TAKA U-16

Andhra, K'taka set kids' social media age limits

MPOST BUREAU

AMARAVATI/BENGALURU:

Andhra Pradesh and Karnataka on Friday became the first two Indian states to ban the use of social media for children, albeit in different age groups.

Australia and Indonesia have affected similar bans, amid a global debate over the need to safeguard children from the addiction to social media.

While the TDP-led NDA ruled Andhra Pradesh said social media will be prohibited for children below 13 years of age, the Congress government in neighbouring Karnataka said the ban will apply for those under 16.

Addressing the Andhra assembly, Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu said they were debating whether to extend this ban to children between 13 and 16 years of age.

"Definitely, we will make sure that within 90 days those below 13 years of age are not able to use social media," said Naidu.

The CM said his government will take a call on banning social media for teenagers between 13 and 16 years.



Australia, Indonesia have affected similar bans, amid a global debate over the need to safeguard children from the addiction to social media

Karnataka Chief Minister Siddaramaiah announced a ban on use of social media for those under the age of 16 years.

The move aimed at preventing adverse effects on children was met with both encouragement and skepticism.

"With the objective of preventing adverse effects of increasing mobile usage on children, usage of social media will be Continued on P4

Mamata: Will expose BJP-EC conspiracy to disenfranchise Bengal voters

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: Mamata Banerjee on Friday began a sit-in protest at Dharmatala, two days ahead of the arrival of the full bench of the Election Commission of India (ECI).

The protest, currently scheduled to run daily from 10 am to 8 pm, is aimed at opposing the voter revision process ahead of the 2026 Assembly elections and in such a "hasty and unplanned way". Continued on P4

SERVICE CALLING

» Rajeshwari Suve M and Akansh Dhull have got the second and third ranks, respectively

» Agnihotri secured the first rank, with medical science as his optional subject, in his third attempt

» He has done MBBS (Bachelor of Medicine and Bachelor of Surgery) from the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), Jodhpur, Rajasthan



"I am extremely happy at this achievement. It's an incredible feeling," Agnihotri said from his residence in Rawatb-hata under Chittorgarh district of Rajasthan. He credited his success to

family members saying they have been his biggest source of inspiration.

"They (family) prioritised me and my efforts, and ensured that I focused on the exam. I dedicate Continued on P4

TOTAL 958 CANDIDATES QUALIFY

Anuj Agnihotri: From AIIMS graduate to UPSC topper

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Anuj Agnihotri, an AIIMS graduate, has topped the coveted civil services examination 2025, results of which were declared by the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) on Friday.

Rajeshwari Suve M and Akansh Dhull have got the second and third ranks, respectively.

Agnihotri secured the first rank, with medical science as his optional subject, in his third attempt.

He has done MBBS (Bachelor of Medicine and Bachelor of Surgery) from the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), Jodhpur, Rajasthan.

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SOUTHWEST DELHI'S UTTAM NAGAR

Vehicles set ablaze and road blocked amid protests over Holi clash killing

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Tension escalated in southwest Delhi's Uttam Nagar on Friday as a car and a motorcycle were set on fire, and a massive protest by Hindu political outfits blocked traffic for several hours here, following the death of a 26-year-old man in a clash during Holi celebrations.

According to police sources, members of the Bajrang Dal and Vishwa Hindu Parishad staged a protest under the Uttam Nagar East metro station, blocking the main road and bringing traffic to a standstill for hours as they demanded strict action against those involved in the killing.

Several protesters sat on the road and raised slogans in the busy locality. Long queues of vehicles were seen stretching on both sides of the road, as the agitation continued for hours.

Police personnel had a difficult time dispersing the protesters and restoring traffic movement in the area. A senior police officer said their primary focus was to clear the road so that normal traffic movement could resume and commuters



Police sources said mild force was used to disperse the protesters

ers would not face prolonged inconvenience.

"Our teams worked to remove the protesters from the road so vehicular movement could be restored. Several ambulances were also stuck in the traffic," the officer said.

Police sources said mild force was used to disperse the protesters after repeated appeals failed to convince them to vacate the road. "Protesters were trying to disturb traffic. Our teams used very light force to disperse them from the spot so that the vehicular movement could become smooth," the officer said.

Heavy police deployment was made in the area to maintain law and order. Several SHOs from the nearby police stations were also asked to reach the protest site to help manage the situation and regulate traffic, according to officials. Police also deployed drones to keep a close watch on the protesters and identify those involved in blocking the road and disrupting traffic. Meanwhile, amid the prevailing tension in the locality, a car and a motorcycle parked in Uttam Nagar's JJ Colony area were set on fire on Friday afternoon, officials said.

HIGHLIGHTS

» Police personnel had a difficult time dispersing the protesters and restoring traffic movement

» A senior police officer said their primary focus was to clear the road so that normal traffic movement could resume and commuters would not face any prolonged inconvenience

The Delhi Fire Services (DFS) said it received a call at 2.02 pm regarding a fire involving two vehicles -- a car and a motorcycle. "Fire tenders were rushed to the spot, and the flames were doused promptly. Police have been informed about the matter," a DFS officer said.

Police said no injuries were reported in the fire incident, and an investigation has been initiated to ascertain who set the vehicles ablaze.

Security has been tightened across the locality following the death of Tarun, 26, who succumbed to injuries

after a clash between two families (from different communities) during Holi celebrations on Wednesday.

Additional police and paramilitary personnel have been deployed in the area as a precautionary measure to prevent any escalation of the situation.

According to police, the incident took place in the JJ Colony when a dispute broke out between members of the two families during Holi celebrations.

Preliminary investigation suggested that the altercation began after coloured water from a balloon splashed on a woman, leading to a heated argument that soon escalated into a violent clash, police said.

Several people from both sides sustained injuries during the fight. Tarun suffered serious injuries and was rushed to a hospital, where he later died during treatment.

Family members alleged the clash began after an 11-year-old's water balloon splashed a woman, triggering a fight. Tarun was later attacked and died during treatment. Police arrested four people and apprehended a juvenile.

Ghaziabad most-polluted city in India during '25-26 winters

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Ghaziabad was the most-polluted city in India during the winter season in 2025-26, followed by Noida and Delhi, according to an air-quality analysis by the Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air (CREA).

At least 204 out of 238 Indian cities with sufficient monitoring data recorded average winter PM2.5 concentrations above India's National Ambient Air Quality Standards (NAAQS), up from last year's 173 cities, the CREA analysis said. The analysis was based on Continuous Ambient Air Quality Monitoring Stations (CAAQMS) data from the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) from October 1, 2025, to February 28, 2026.

"Ghaziabad ranked as the most polluted city in India during winter 2025-26, recording an average PM2.5 concentration of 172 µg/m3. Noida ranked the second most polluted city, with an average concentration of 166 µg/m3. Delhi ranked third, recording an average PM2.5 concentration of 163 µg/m3.

"During the winter 2025-26 period, Delhi experienced 18 'severe' days, 87 'very poor' days, 24 'poor' days, 15 'moderate' days, six 'satisfactory' days,



and only one 'good' day," the CREA analysis said.

Greater Noida, Bahadurgarh, Dharuhera, Gurgaon, Bhiwadi, Charkhi Dadri and Baghat completed the list of the 10 most polluted cities, with Greater Noida ranking fourth and Baghat 10th. Uttar Pradesh and Haryana accounted for four cities each among the top 10 most-polluted cities, along with one city each from Delhi and Rajasthan.

At the state level, Haryana recorded the highest number of cities where all monitored locations exceeded the PM2.5 NAAQS, with 24 cities breaching the standard. Andhra Pradesh (nine cities), Punjab (eight), West Bengal (seven) and Gujarat (six) also recorded exceedances across all monitored cities.

Rajasthan (33 of 34 cities), Maharashtra (30 of 31 cities), Bihar (23 of 24 cities), Uttar Pradesh (17 of 20 cities), Odi-

sha (13 of 14 cities) and Madhya Pradesh (11 of 13 cities) also recorded high proportions of cities exceeding the national standard. Chamarajanagar in Karnataka was the cleanest city in India during the winter of 2025-26, with an average PM2.5 concentration of 19 µg/m3. The 10 cleanest cities included eight from Karnataka and one each from Madhya Pradesh and Meghalaya.

"The comparison between the last two winters shows that widespread non-compliance continues, with more cities breaching the national standard in winter 2025-26 than in the previous winter.

Winter 2025-26 data showed most Indian cities exceeded national PM2.5 limits, with all surpassing WHO guidelines. Experts urged nationwide reduction targets and stronger control of gaseous pollutants contributing to secondary particulate pollution.

Six-yr-old's boy body with slit throat found

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A throat-slit body of a six-year-old boy was found inside an under-construction building in outer Delhi's Ranhola area, with his family alleging the mother was involved in the killing, police said on Friday.

According to the family, the mother of the child -- allegedly in an extramarital affair with a truck driver -- had left home with the boy on Tuesday, and has been missing since, police said. The boy lived with his parents and siblings in a rented accommodation in Ranhola, they said, adding that his father works as a daily-wage labourer.

The child's body was found inside an under-construction building in the area on Thursday afternoon. Police suspect the child may have been killed elsewhere and the body later dumped at the construction site, as there are limited blood stains at the scene. A knife and an iron rod have also been recovered from the spot.

The deceased's family has alleged that the woman was

Child's body was found in an under-construction building

in a relationship with a truck driver from her native village in Bihar's Chhapra district and had frequent quarrels with her husband over the issue, a senior police officer said.

Family members have claimed that the woman would occasionally leave home with the children and return later, but this time she left with the boy on Tuesday and did not come back, police said.

"The body has been shifted to the Sanjay Gandhi Hospital mortuary for post-mortem. A case of murder has been registered, and further investigation is underway," the officer said.

Teams have been formed to trace the missing woman and examine all possible angles in the case, the officer said, adding that the motive behind the killing will be ascertained only after the accused are identified and questioned.

Couple arrested for knifepoint robbery: Police

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police have arrested a husband-wife duo for allegedly robbing a passenger at knifepoint inside a public bus in outer Delhi on Wednesday morning.

Police said the incident was reported through a PCR call received at the Alipur police station. The accused have been identified as Deepak (26) and his wife Dipali (23), residents of Swaroop Nagar in Delhi.

According to officials, the robbery took place on March 5 when the complainant, Ravi Kumar, a resident of Swaroop Nagar, was travelling in a bus towards The Mann School in Khera Khurd. At around 11.50 am, when the bus reached the ESR near Om Dharam Kanta in the Khera Kalan area, the couple allegedly targeted him.

Police said the woman created a diversion by accusing Kumar of misbehaving with her, while her husband threatened him with a knife-like object and demanded his belongings.

Fearing for his safety, Kumar handed over his OPPO mobile phone and wallet containing Rs 7,600 in cash along with his Aadhaar card, PAN card and driving licence.

The bus conductor alerted the police, and the woman was caught on the spot by the bus staff and the complainant. The man attempted to flee by jumping off the moving bus but was soon apprehended by a police team patrolling nearby.

Police recovered the victim's mobile phone, wallet with identity cards, Rs 4,400 in cash and the knife used in the crime. A case has been registered and further investigation is underway.

Over 35 candidates from Jamia's Residential Coaching Academy clear UPSC-2025

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: As many as 38 candidates from Jamia Millia Islamia's Residential Coaching Academy (RCA) have qualified in the UPSC Civil Services Examination-2025, the results of which were declared on Friday.

An official said the successful candidates include 15 women, underlining JMI's role in promoting equity and inclusivity. Four candidates secured positions within the top 50, with All India Ranks (AIR) 7, 14, 24, and 29.

JMI Vice Chancellor Mazhar Asif congratulated the successful candidates and appreciated the efforts of the faculty and administrative staff of the RCA's Centre for Coaching and Career Planning.

"On behalf of the entire JMI fraternity, I extend my heartfelt congratulations to all our brilliant candidates

who have done us proud. The extraordinary success of our RCA-trained students showcases JMI's culture of hard work, perseverance, and determination that are the key ingredients for success in one of the country's toughest examinations," Asif said.

"JMI is committed to serving the nation by contributing to India's administrative machinery and nurturing future leaders for the civil services examinations," he added.

JMI's registrar Md. Mahtab Alam Rizvi also congratulated the students, calling it a proud moment for the university, and thanked all the teaching and non-teaching staff.

Calling it a proud moment, he congratulated the successful candidates. RCA in-charge Samina Bano credited the students' hard work and support from the Jamia Millia Islamia administration.

NOIDA INT'L AIRPORT DGCA grants aerodrome licence

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) has granted an aerodrome licence to the Noida International Airport at Jewar in Uttar Pradesh, marking a key milestone for the project as it moves closer to becoming a major aviation hub for the National Capital Region.

The licence has been issued to Yamuna International Airport Private Limited (YIAPL), the developer of the airport and a wholly owned subsidiary of Zurich Airport International AG.

The airport is being developed under a public-private partnership between the Uttar Pradesh government and the Union government. The concession agreement for the project came into effect on October 1, 2021, and is valid for 40 years.

Licensed under the 'Public Use' category for all-weather operations, the airport will feature a runway measuring 3,900 metres in length and 45 metres in width, oriented in the 10/28 direction. It will also be equipped with an Instrument



In the first phase, the airport will have one runway and a terminal capable of handling 12 million passengers annually

Landing System and Aeronautical Ground Lighting to enable round-the-clock operations.

The facility will include parking bays for 24 Code C aircraft and Aircraft Rescue and Fire Fighting services of Category 9, allowing wide-body aircraft such as the Boeing 777-300ER to operate from the airport.

The project is being developed in four phases and will include a multi-modal cargo hub. In the first phase, the air-

port will have one runway and a terminal capable of handling 12 million passengers annually. Once all four phases are completed, the airport is expected to handle up to 70 million passengers each year.

Civil Aviation Minister Rammohan Naidu Kinjarapu said the airport would strengthen aviation infrastructure and boost tourism and economic growth in the National Capital Region and Uttar Pradesh.

Only 50 of Capital's 194 police stations have paralegal volunteers; 1 POCSO victim provided aid in 2025: RTI

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: Only 50 of Delhi's 194 police stations currently have paralegal volunteers and only one victim of a POCSO case availed their assistance in 2025, despite a Supreme Court mandate on it, an RTI query has revealed. Paralegal volunteers (PLVs) work in three shifts of eight hours each at the 50 police stations, which

comes around to a fourth of all stations in the national capital, data provided by the Delhi State Legal Services Authority (DSLSA) showed.

However, their utilisation in Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) cases appears minimal. According to replies received from district legal services authorities, only one POCSO case in 2025 in southwest district involved

the assignment of a PLV to assist the victim.

The replies to the RTI query also indicate that the volunteers are not specifically deployed for POCSO cases and are primarily engaged under the 'Missing Children' project.

Data shows that in the northeast district, four of the 10 police stations — Gokalpuri, Khajuri Khas, New Usmanpur and Karawal Nagar

— have PLVs deployed. In New Delhi district, only two police stations, Sagarpur and Vasant Kunj South, have such volunteers.

In south district, five of the 14 police stations — Sangam Vihar, Fatehpur Beri, Neb Sarai, Ambedkar Nagar and Mehrauli — have PLV deployment. In Shahdara district, Seemapuri, Nand Nagri, Harsh Vihar and Jafraabad police stations

have PLV services. North district, which has 15 police stations, has PLVs deployed in Alipur, Jahangirpuri, Bawana, Bhalaswa Dairy, Samaypur Badli, Narela, Shahbad Dairy and Swaroop Nagar police stations. Several Delhi police stations lack PLVs for POCSO cases. The Supreme Court directed states to verify deployment, address gaps and ensure trained support.

AHEAD OF SUMMER

MCD repairs 431 kms of road, deploys 52 sweeping machines, 600 workers for dust control, sanitation

OUR CORRESPONDENT



NEW DELHI: To curb dust pollution and strengthen sanitation across the national capital ahead of summer, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi has deployed 52 sweeping machines, water sprinklers and over 600 workers while speeding up road repairs.

Officials said 52 mechanical road sweepers are currently operating on Public Works Department roads with widths above 60 feet, covering around 1,450 km of road length.

"With the existing fleet, about 3,400 km of roads are being swept on alternate days, and the machines' operational hours have been extended by two hours to improve coverage," they said.

Nearly 600 sanitation workers have also been deployed

Nearly 600 sanitation workers have also been deployed along these corridors to remove municipal solid waste, plastic and litter from the roadsides

along these corridors to remove municipal solid waste, plastic and litter from the roadsides, officials added.

The civic body has also carried out road strengthening in several parts of the capital. Between April 2025 and February 2026, roads covering

about 431 km were resurfaced or strengthened, while another 1,300 km of stretches have been identified for repairs.

The corporation said during the same period, 29,449 potholes spanning about 67,664 square metres were repaired.

At least 167 water sprinklers

and 28 mobile anti-smog guns have been deployed across city roads to control dust. Another 20 anti-smog guns have been installed at key facilities such as construction and demolition waste plants, landfill sites and waste-to-energy plants.

Officials said additional sanitation resources have also been deployed across all 12 municipal zones, including around 220 machines such as Hywas, loaders, tipper and JCBs, to improve waste management and overall cleanliness.

Man posing as godman cheats woman of locket

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have arrested a 34-year-old man for allegedly posing as an occultist and cheating a senior citizen in northwest Delhi's Pitampura area.

The accused, identified as Mithun, a resident of Kalandar Colony in Dilshad Garden, was arrested following a complaint lodged at the Maurya Enclave police station. Police recovered the victim's gold locket from his possession.

According to officials, the complainant, Raj Rani (65), was approached by the accused near the Tata Power NDPL

office at GP Block on March 3 while she was returning home. Mithun allegedly introduced himself as a saint who could solve her problems.

Another accomplice joined them and pretended to seek help from him to gain the woman's trust.

The duo persuaded her to walk 151 steps as part of a ritual and later asked her to hand over her jewellery for the ceremony. They fled after taking her gold locket and ear tops.

Police identified and arrested Mithun using CCTV footage and technical surveillance. Efforts are underway to trace his associate.

DEFENCE MINISTER RAJNATH SINGH SAID HE IS “DEEPLY SADDENED” BY DEATHS

Two pilots killed in Su-30MKI fighter jet crash in Assam

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Two pilots of the Indian Air Force (IAF) were killed in a crash of a Su-30 MKI multi-role fighter jet in Assam's Karbi Anglong district.

The IAF confirmed on Friday the deaths of Squadron Leader Anuj and Flight Lieutenant Purvesh Duragkar, a day after the Russian-origin aircraft went missing.

The jet was on a training sortie and disappeared from radar shortly after taking off from Jorhat airbase on Thursday.

The IAF headquarters

ordered a court of inquiry into the crash.

“The IAF acknowledges the loss of Sqn Ldr Anuj and Flt Lt Purvesh Duragkar, who sustained fatal injuries in the Su-30 crash,” the IAF said in a brief statement.

“All personnel of the IAF express sincere condolences, and stand firmly with the bereaved family in this time of grief,” it said.

Communication with the aircraft was lost at 7:42 pm on Thursday, officials had said.

At approximately 1:00 am on Friday, the IAF confirmed that the Su-30MKI which dis-



Debris from the Su-30 MKI multi-role fighter jet after a crash

PTI

appeared from radar on Thursday has crashed.

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh said he is “deeply sad-

In Short

» The jet was on a training sortie and disappeared from radar shortly after taking off from Jorhat airbase on Thursday

» It is learnt that the jet was part of a squadron based in Tezpur city in the northeastern state

dened” by the deaths of Squadron Leader Anuj and Flight Lieutenant Duragkar in the “tragic Su-30 crash.”

“Their courage and service

to the nation will always be remembered with pride and gratitude. My heartfelt condolences to the bereaved families. The nation stands firmly with them in this hour of grief,” he said on social media.

It is learnt that the jet was part of a squadron based in Tezpur city in the northeastern state. Flight Lt Duragkar had come to his home in Nagpur 10 days ago for a family get-together, his grief-stricken father Ravindra Duragkar said, adding he had the last telephonic conversation with his son on Wednesday.

His also said his 28-year-old

son had taken part in Operation Sindoor.

In Gurugram, friends and relatives of Squadron Leader Vashisht gathered at his house in Sector 22B after receiving news of his death.

According to a family friend, Vashisht was originally from Bhiwani district of Haryana and his family was preparing for his wedding.

The Su-30MKI is a two-seater multirole long-range fighter jet developed by Russian aircraft manufacturer Sukhoi. It is now built under licence by Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd (HAL) for the IAF.

The IAF operates a fleet of over 260 Su-30MKI jets. The multi-role aircraft has been in service with the IAF for over two decades and nearly 10 Su-30MKIs have been lost so far.

In recent years, a Su-30 MKI fighter plane had crashed in Nashik district of Maharashtra in June 2024.

Another Sukhoi-30 jet had crashed in January 2023 after taking off from the Gwalior airbase. Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma expressed profound grief over the deaths of the two pilots and conveyed his condolences to the bereaved families.

From Page 1

Day 7: War

The stated goals and timelines for the war have repeatedly shifted, as the US has at times suggested it seeks to topple Iran's government or elevate new leadership from within.

The war has already caused a spike in oil prices, and Qatar's energy minister warned that it could “bring down the economies of the world,” predicting a widespread shutdown of Gulf energy exports that could send oil to \$150 a barrel.

Iran meanwhile launched missile and drone attacks at Israel, as well as Kuwait, Qatar, Saudi Arabia and Bahrain, all countries that host US forces. There were no immediate reports of casualties.

The war has killed at least 1,230 people in Iran, more than 120 in Lebanon and around a dozen in Israel, according to officials in those countries. Six US troops have been killed.

Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian said Friday that “some countries” had begun mediation efforts in the conflict, without elaborating.

The US military said early Friday that it struck an Iranian drone carrier, setting it ablaze. The US military's Central Command released black-and-white footage of the burning carrier. The Iranian military did not immediately acknowledge the attack.

The drone carrier, the IRIS Shahid Bagheri, is a converted container ship with a 180-meter-long (yard) runway for drones. The vessel can travel up to 22,000 nautical miles without needing to refuel in ports, reports said at the time of its 2025 inauguration.

Earlier in the week, an American submarine sank an Iranian frigate off the coast of Sri Lanka as it was returning from an exercise hosted by the Indian navy that the US also joined. Sri Lanka's navy rescued 32 crew members and recovered 87 bodies.

Qatar said it intercepted a drone attack targeting Al Udeid Air Base, which hosts the forward headquarters of the US Central Command.

Air raid sirens sounded in Bahrain, where the Interior Ministry said Iranian strikes targeted two hotels and a residential building. It said there were no casualties. In Kuwait, where the six US soldiers were killed Sunday, the army said air defenses were activated when missile and drone attacks breached its airspace.

In Israel, the sound of explosions could be heard in Tel Aviv early Friday morning after a warning about missiles incoming from Iran, as air defense systems worked to intercept the barrage.

Meanwhile, the US Embassy in Kuwait shut down after retaliatory Iranian strikes on the country, becoming the second American diplomatic mission to fully halt work as the war in Iran escalates. Kuwait is also where six American soldiers were killed by an Iranian drone on Sunday.

Claim on Navy

which marked a major escalation in the conflict between the US and Iran outside of the Persian Gulf.

There were reports that alleged that the Indian Navy provided some inputs on the frigate to the US military.

The claims are completely “baseless and preposterous,” the sources said.

Iran reacted sharply to the sinking of the ship.

“IRIS Dena was a training ship. It was invited by the Indian Navy to take part in an exercise. They went there as guests. They were unarmed,” Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said.

“Attacking such a ship is a war crime,” he said.

Hours after the strike on the warship, the Pentagon released a short video of the sinking of the frigate.

US Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth said at a Pentagon media briefing on Wednesday that it was the first sinking of an enemy warship by a torpedo since World War II.

IRIS Dena participated was part of Indian Navy's premier multilateral maritime exercise Milan.

The mega exercise last month saw participation of 42 warships and submarines, including 18 ships from friendly foreign countries.

The warship had also featured in the International Fleet Review hosted by the Indian Navy in Vishakapatnam last month.

PTI

News channel

for Television Rating Agencies in India, issued by the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting on January 16, 2014 for television rating, Broadcast Audience Research Council (BARC) is a registered television rating agency.

The Ministry of Information and Broadcasting, in its directive, said that it has observed that, amidst the ongoing Israel-Iran conflict, certain news TV channels are displaying “unwarranted sensationalism and speculative content,” which “may potentially create panic” among the general public, specially those having friends and family in the affected areas or residing in the affected areas.

The Clause 24.2 of the policy guidelines, prescribes that “The company shall be required to comply with any orders, regulations, guidelines, directions, etc., issued by the Ministry from time to time.

“Therefore, in the public interest, the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting hereby directs M/s BARC to immediately withhold reporting the Television Rating Points (TRPs) for news TV channels for a period of four weeks or until further directions, whichever is earlier,” the directive said.

PTI

Indian refiners

to reduce money flowing to Moscow's war effort in Ukraine.

India's imports of Russian crude in February fell to 1.04 million barrels per day - the lowest since November 2022. The US had made cuts to tariffs on Indian goods contingent on New Delhi reducing its purchases of Russian crude.

This left several ship loads of Russian oil stranded on high-sea, sources said.

India, which had turned to buying discounted Russian crude following Western sanctions in February 2022, is now adjusting its purchases amid disruptions in Middle East supplies.

The country had previously imported record volumes of Russian oil when cargoes were available at deep discounts, helping refiners offset rising global crude prices. Russian cargoes hit a peak of 2.15 million barrels in

May 2023.

However, with the widening West Asia conflict blocking shipments through the Strait of Hormuz and raising concerns over oil and LNG supplies from the Middle East, Indian refiners are now balancing purchases from both Russian cargoes at sea and other sources to ensure an uninterrupted domestic fuel supply.

“President Trump's energy agenda has resulted in oil and gas production reaching the highest levels ever recorded,” US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said. “To enable oil to keep flowing into the global market, the Treasury Department is issuing a temporary 30-day waiver to allow Indian refiners to purchase Russian oil.”

Calling the move a stopgap measure, he said Washington expects India to eventually buy more US oil.

“India is an essential partner of the United States, and we fully anticipate that New Delhi will ramp up purchases of US oil. This stop-gap measure will alleviate pressure caused by Iran's attempt to take global energy hostage,” Bessent said in a post on X.

The short-term measure will not provide significant financial benefit to the Russian government as it only authorises transactions involving oil already stranded at sea, he added.

India, which has inventories to cover for 25 days of demand for crude (raw material for making fuels like petrol and diesel), sources 40-50 per cent of its crude oil needs from the Middle East through the Strait of Hormuz. The escalating conflict in West Asia has effectively shut the Strait.

Sources said Indian refiners are now buying the Russian oil to build inventories.

There are more than a dozen tankers with Russian oil in the Arabian Sea and the Bay of Bengal, sources said, adding that another eight vessels are idling off Singapore and could reach India within days. Beyond that, ships laden with Russian oil are also in the Mediterranean Sea and the Suez canal which would also reach India in under a month.

“With nearly 50 per cent of India's crude imports transiting the Strait of Hormuz, the country remains highly exposed to potential supply disruptions,” said Sumit Ritolia, an analyst at the data intelligence firm Kpler. “The US waiver allowing additional purchases of Russian crude over base load offers short-term relief, though competition from Chinese buyers for the same barrels could limit the extent of India's benefit.”

Indian refiners had already been importing around 1 million barrels per day of Russian crude in recent months, meaning the waiver effectively acts as a green signal to lift volumes above this base load, he said.

“As of early March, around 130 million barrels of Russian crude remain on the water, including significant volumes across the Indian Ocean, Red Sea/Suez routes, and around Singapore, which could potentially be redirected toward Indian ports if commercial deals are finalised.

“With the waiver now in place, refiners could quickly resume purchases, potentially pushing Russian inflows around 1.6 to 2 million barrels per day in the near term,” he said.

While this provides a short-term logistical buffer, it cannot fully offset India's 2.6 million barrels per day exposure to Middle Eastern crude, and competition from Chinese buyers for the same Russian barrels will limit the upside.

“For Indian refiners, renewed access to Russian crude would

support feedstock security and margins. However, there has been no official indication of product export curbs from the Indian government. In the near term, refiners are likely to prioritise domestic fuel availability and comfortable stock levels, meaning the increase in crude availability may not immediately translate into higher product exports. Export flows would likely rise only once domestic requirements are satisfied,” he said.

AP, Karnataka

banned for children under the age of 16,” Siddaramaiah said while presenting the state Budget for 2026-27 in the state Assembly in Bengaluru.

Later, addressing a press conference, he said children below 16 years old can keep a mobile phone, but they cannot use social media.

“We will ban social media for them,” he said.

Responding to queries on how it will be regulated — in schools, colleges or at home, Siddaramaiah said. “We will formulate a programme for that. Once the programme is finalised, we will inform you.”

In January, state minister for Electronics, IT/BT Priyanka Kharge had informed the Legislative Assembly that the government was holding consultations regarding measures to be put in place for responsible use of artificial intelligence and social media, especially among children.

The central government's Economic Survey tabled in Parliament in January this year said age-based access to online platforms should be considered while also cutting down online teaching to avoid digital addiction.

Manohar N H, a resident of Jalahalli in Bengaluru who has two school-going children — a 16-year-old boy and a 13-year-old girl — said that restricting social media for children below 16 may be good in some ways, but implementing it would be difficult.

Appreciating the move, Dr Saritha Nagaraj, Consultant – Psychology and Child Development, Motherhood Hospital in the city said that with this, the risk of poor mental health among children and teenagers — including symptoms of depression, anxiety, poor sleep, and body image issues arising from unhealthy comparisons, which can further lead to disordered eating — will be reduced.

“Their cognitive performance and emotional regulation are also likely to improve. Exposure to dangerous content will decrease, and this could help improve attention span as well as academic performance,” she added.

Dr Rakshay Shetty, Clinical Director, Pediatric Services Head, Pediatric Intensive Care Services, Rainbow Children's Hospital said that while there are a lot of disadvantages of excess use of mobile devices in children, considering its ill-effects on their psychology, at the same time it provides a lot of practical utility for parents, teachers and children.

“We need to look at a balanced solution because a blanket ban can be counterproductive since implementing it is not practical and it might remain like a paper tiger where there is a rule but no one follows it. Instead, giving guidelines on how to practically use mobile devices and limit their excess use would be more practical,” he said.

BJP Rajya Sabha MP from the state Lahar Singh Siroya, however, welcomed the move in

a social media post on ‘X’ saying he had raised this issue via a special mention in parliament.

“Prime Minister (Narendra) Modi had also spoken about securing the interest of our younger generations at the AI summit, recently. I had further asked for restrictions on smartphone use among children in my parliament speech. I hope this too will be looked into seriously,” he said.

Aparajita Bharti, Founding Partner at the Quantum Hub opined that a social media ban however is unlikely to have the desired effect in India given the high incidence of shared device usage in households. Further, it is also an imperfect measure, given that it is hard to define ‘social media’ and the assumption that only a certain kind of platform is harmful for children is not grounded in evidence.

In 2025, Australia became the first country to ban social media for children under 16 by blocking access to platforms including TikTok, YouTube, Instagram and Facebook.

Indonesia has also banned social media for children under the age of 16.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Delhi's new L-G Sandhu

In a post on X, Sandhu said, “Deeply honoured and grateful to Prime Minister Narendra Modi for the opportunity to serve the people of Delhi as Lieutenant Governor. Grateful also to Home Minister Amit Shah for his trust and support.

“Committed to serving the people of Delhi and the nation with dedication and humility,” he added.

Sandhu's appointment was part of a major reshuffle of gubernatorial posts effected in several states and Union territories by President Murmu late on Thursday night.

Sandhu, a 1988-batch Indian Foreign Service officer, was one of the most experienced Indian diplomats on United States affairs. He served in the Indian Mission in Washington DC multiple times.

He was India's ambassador to the US from February 2020 to January 2024. Previously, he served as the deputy chief of mission at the embassy in Washington from July 2013 to January 2017 and as the first secretary (political) from 1997 to 2000, with the responsibility to liaise with the US Congress.

Mamata

Targeting the BJP and ECI, Banerjee said: “I will expose the BJP-EC conspiracy to disenfranchise Bengali voters,” and asserted that the “BJP would be under 50 seats this time”

Several Trinamool Congress leaders, including party's national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee, along with eminent Bengali artists and writers, addressed the gathering on Friday. Mamata Banerjee, however, is scheduled to deliver her speech on Saturday after spending the night at the protest site.

Recalling Banerjee's historic protest for voter identity cards in 1993, Abhishek Banerjee said: “She was the only leader who fought for the rights of voters in 1993. In 2026, once again in the fight to protect democratic rights, she will win.” He also alleged that the Election Commission was functioning as a “B team of the BJP” and attempting to defeat the ma-mati-manush. “We have fought this conspiracy on the ground, in Parliament and even in court, and the BJP

will not be allowed to gain any advantage in the polls,” he said.

Urging voters to socially boycott the BJP, Abhishek claimed that several voters were being harassed due to the “hasty and unplanned” revision process and alleged that around 172 people had died amid the anxiety surrounding it. “Before the 2021 Assembly elections, there was a call of ‘No vote to BJP’. This time the call should be ‘boycott BJP,’” he said, adding that even a small number of BJP MLAs could attempt to “undermine the Constitution.”

Alleging large-scale irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, Abhishek Banerjee said the exercise appeared aimed at achieving a “pre-fixed political target”. According to him, the final list shows that 63.66 lakh names have been deleted, while over 60 lakh voters have been kept “under adjudication”, leaving uncertainty over their participation in the upcoming Assembly elections. He further alleged that senior BJP leaders, including Union Home Minister Amit Shah, had earlier indicated that around 1.2 crore names would be removed from Bengal's voter rolls.

Targeting the Union government, Abhishek Banerjee said the Centre had attempted to withhold Bengal's rightful funds while the state government continued welfare initiatives such as payments under the 100 days' work scheme, housing assistance and the Lakshmir Bhandar scheme from its own resources. He also questioned why the term “logical discrepancy” had not been used in BJP-ruled states. “Why is it being imposed only in Bengal? In reality, this is being done to snatch away Bengal's voting rights,” he said.

Meanwhile, the TMC national general secretary also wrote to the Election Commission on the same day, raising concerns over the publication of the final and supplementary electoral rolls and alleging a lack of transparency in the process. In the letter, the party demanded formal notification that voters included through supplementary rolls would be treated as part of the final roll, daily publication of supplementary rolls as directed by the Supreme Court of India, and public disclosure of adjudication decisions in a transparent manner.

Anuj Agnihotri

this achievement to my family,” Agnihotri said.

Second rank holder Rajeshwari, who has a Bachelor of Engineering (BE) degree in Electrical and Electronics Engineering from Anna University, Chennai, had chosen sociology as her optional subject.

Akansha, a Bachelor of Commerce (BCom) graduate from University of Delhi, bagged the third rank with commerce & accountancy as his optional subject.

Among the finally qualified candidates, top five comprises one woman and four men.

Raghav Jhunjunwala and Ishan Bhatnagar have got the fourth and fifth ranks, respectively.

Jhunjunwala, who has a Bachelor of Arts (BA) in Economics from University of Delhi, secured the fourth position with economics as his optional subject.

Bhatnagar, who holds BA LLB (Hons) from National Law University, Delhi, got fifth rank with sociology as his optional subject.

The top 25 candidates comprise 11 women and 14 men.

A total of 958 candidates -- 659 men and 299 women -- have qualified the examination and are recommended for appointment to different central civil services, the Commission said, adding that the candidature of 348 recommended candidates has been kept provisional.

“The UPSC has declared the final results of the CSE 2025 today. Congrats to all successful candidates as you begin a career of service to the nation. For those who did not make it - the learning from this journey will guide you in the paths ahead,” UPSC chairman Ajay Kumar said in a post on X.

The civil services examination (CSE) is conducted annually in three stages -- preliminary, main and interview -- by the Commission to select officers of the Indian Administrative Service (IAS), Indian Foreign Service (IFS) and Indian Police Service (IPS) among others.

The civil services (preliminary) examination, 2025 was conducted on May 25, last year. A total of 9,37,876 candidates applied for this examination, out of which 5,76,793 actually appeared in the test, the UPSC said in a statement.

As many as 14,161 candidates qualified for appearance in the written (main) examination which was held in August, 2025. Of these, 2,736 candidates qualified for the personality test (interview) of the examination.

Educational qualifications of the top 25 successful candidates range from graduation in engineering, humanities, science, commerce, law, medical science and mass media from premier institutions of the country such as Indian Institutes of Technology (IIT), National Law University (NLU), AIIMS, Delhi Technological University (DTU), Anna University, University of Delhi and University of Mumbai among others.

Top 25 successful candidates have opted for subjects like anthropology, commerce & accountancy, chemistry, economics, electrical engineering, history, mathematics, medical science, philosophy, political science & international relations, public administration and sociology as their optional choice in the written (main) examination.

The UPSC said the recommended candidates also include 42 persons with benchmark disability -- 10 orthopedically handicapped, 14 visually challenged, nine hearing impaired and nine with multiple disabilities.

As many as 258 other candidates have been put on a reserve list, the statement said.

Of the total qualified candidates, 317 belong to the General category, 104 from Economically Weaker Section (EWS), 306 from Other Backward Class (OBC), 158 from Scheduled Caste (SC) and 73 from Scheduled Tribe (ST) categories.

The result of two candidates has been kept withheld, the Commission said.

The central government had reported 1,087 vacancies to be filled through the 2025 examination.

The UPSC has a “facilitation counter” near the examination hall in its campus.

Candidates can obtain any information/clarification regarding their examinations/recruitments on the working days between 10 am to 5 pm in person or over telephone numbers 23385271/23381125/2309854, the statement said.

“Marks will be available on the website within 15 days from the date of declaration of result,” it added. Banaras Hindu University's postgraduate Shakti Dubey had bagged the first rank in the civil services examination 2024.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

POST-BUDGET WEBINAR ON 'AGRICULTURE AND RURAL TRANSFORMATION'

PM: Focus on making agri products export-oriented, globally competitive

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday asked farmers to leverage India's diverse climate to increase productivity and export strength, and stressed on scaling up high-value crop produce to make the country's agri products globally competitive.

Addressing a post-Budget webinar on 'Agriculture and Rural Transformation', Modi called for a 'unified approach involving experts, industry, and farmers to meet global quality and branding standards', and highlighted the importance of setting clear goals to connect local farmers with global markets.

"Today the world markets are opening, and global demand is shifting... It is necessary to have more discussion on making our agriculture export-oriented. We have a diverse climate, and we must take full advantage of it. We are rich in agro-climatic zones," he said.

The Prime Minister noted that the export-oriented production would lead to rural employment through processing and value addition.



Prime Minister Narendra Modi addresses a post-budget webinar on 'Agriculture and Rural Transformation' PFI

The Budget for 2026-27 has also focussed on high-value agriculture, including cashew, cocoa, sandalwood, Modi said, adding that the National Mission on Edible Oil and Pulses and the National Mission on Natural Farming are all strengthening the agriculture sector.

He also highlighted the Budget proposal of promotion of Agarwood in the North East, and temperate nut crops in the Himalayan states. "If we scale high-value agriculture together, it will transform agriculture into a globally competitive sector," Modi added.

The PM said that today the world is becoming more conscious about health, with a

strong focus on holistic health-care and organic food.

"We must place greater emphasis on chemical-free and natural farming. Natural farming creates a highway to reach markets across the world," he said. Stressing that agriculture is also a strategic pillar of India's long-term development journey, he said that the government has continuously strengthened the agriculture sector.

"Nearly 10 crore farmers have received more than Rs 4 lakh crore through the PM Kisan Samman Nidhi. This year's Union Budget gives a strong push to agriculture and rural transformation," Modi added.

On the fisheries sector, Modi

said India is the world's second-largest fish producer with about 4.5 lakh tonnes of fish being produced in our various reservoirs and ponds. There is a potential for an additional 20 lakh tonnes of production, he said, adding, "Fisheries can become a major platform for export growth."

The prime minister emphasised the need for new business models in hatcheries, feed, and logistics to realise the potential of the 'Blue Economy'. "This can become a high-value, high-impact sector for rural prosperity," Modi said.

To mitigate risks, the prime minister advocated for crop diversification and said that states must be inspired to fulfil their budgetary responsibilities.

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Modi highlighted the importance of setting clear goals to connect local farmers with global markets
- » PM noted that export-oriented production would lead to rural employment through processing and value addition

Modi asserted that the government places great emphasis on bringing a 'technology culture' to agriculture, and said that technology only yields results when it is integrated by institutions and entrepreneurs. He called for suggestions on how to effectively merge technology with traditional systems.

Discussing the 'Lakhpati Didi' campaign, Modi set a target of creating 3 crore more such successful women entrepreneurs by 2029 and sought suggestions on how to achieve this goal with greater speed.

He urged entrepreneurs to increase investment in areas of storage and innovation in agri-fintech and supply chains to energise the rural landscape.

Rahul: Politics, int'l relations now moving towards 'darkness'

Congress leader said that Mahatma Gandhi had fought the strongest empire in the world at that time

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLLAM: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Friday said that politics and international relations in current times were "running towards darkness" and away from knowledge.

Gandhi, the Leader of Opposition (LoP) in the Lok Sabha, further said that there was no attempt to understand the other person, be it politics or international relations, and violence was resorted to over disagreements.

"Today, we see in our politics, in international relations, that everyone is running towards darkness and away from knowledge. There is no attempt to understand the other person, you just bomb and kill them."

"It is the same in our politics. You don't agree with someone, you attack that person or become violent towards them," he alleged.

He was speaking at an event here commemorating the centenary of a meeting between Mahatma Gandhi and reformist saint Sree Narayana Guru.

He said that both Gandhi and Narayana Guru were



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi during the Holi festival celebration at the party office, in New Delhi PFI

against such violence and advocated love, respect, forgiveness and understanding between the people.

In his speech, he further said that the Constitution also contains these values advocated by Narayana Guru and Mahatma Gandhi.

He referred to both of them as guides and teachers who showed the direction to be followed by people.

Rahul further said that it was easy for anyone to place flowers in tribute before the statue or image of Narayana Guru, but the challenge was to follow his teachings.

The Congress leader also said that Mahatma Gandhi had fought the strongest empire in

Cong demands discussion on West Asia conflict in Parliament

NEW DELHI: With the second half of the Budget session set to begin next week, the Congress on Friday demanded that a full-fledged short duration discussion be held on the West Asian situation and asserted that a suo motu statement on behalf of the govt would not suffice.

Speaking with news agency, Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh claimed that the govt today stands "shrunkened and diminished" with India's global standing never being "as weak as it is now".

the world at that time and no matter what that they did to him, he was not affected.

Gandhi was inspired by and spoke to people like Narayana Guru during his fight against that strong system.

Fadnavis presents 1st Budget, announces Rs 2L farm loan waiver

MUMBAI: The Maharashtra government on Friday announced a farm loan waiver of up to Rs 2 lakh in the 2026-27 Budget, which also focuses on river-linking projects, women empowerment, youth development, health, start-ups and strengthening social welfare schemes.

CM Devendra Fadnavis, who holds the finance portfolio, presented a Rs 7,69,467 crore Budget in the Assembly, and said Ladki Bahin Yojana, launched ahead of Assembly polls in 2024, will continue with adequate allocation for the scheme targeted at poorer women, who get Rs 1,500 a month.

LS to take up notice on Monday for resolution to remove Birla as Speaker

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Lok Sabha has listed for Monday a notice by Opposition members to move a resolution to remove Om Birla as the Speaker.

Once 50 members of the House stand up upon being called by the Chair, the notice will be considered as admitted. Then the resolution will be discussed and voted upon.

If 50 members do not stand in support of the notice, the resolution cannot be moved.

According to the agenda paper for Monday, the resolution is the only item listed as the business of the day.

Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju had

According to the agenda paper for Monday, the resolution is the only item listed as the business of the day

recently told news agency that the resolution would come up before the House on March 9.

The notice will be moved by three Congress members - Mohamed Jawed, K Suresh and Mallu Ravi.

The proposed resolution questioned the conduct of the Speaker in disallowing the Leader of the Opposition and other Opposition leaders to speak and in "mak-

ing unwarranted allegations against women MPs belonging to the Opposition".

It also referred to the suspension of Opposition MPs for an entire session for raising issues of "public concern and not rebuking ruling party members for making wholly objectionable and derogatory remarks against former PMs".

It further alleged that the Opposition felt Birla has ceased to maintain "an impartial attitude necessary to command the confidence of all sections of the House" and that in his partisan attitude, he is disregarding the rights of members of the House and makes pronouncements and gives rulings calculated to affect and undermine such rights.

Shah announces CISF deployment at all EXIM Ports

Lays foundation stone & inaugurates residential projects worth ₹890 crore

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUNDALI: Union Home minister Amit Shah on Friday said the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) will now be entrusted with the security of all ports in the country, highlighting the expanding role of the force in safeguarding India's critical infrastructure.

Addressing the 57th Raising Day ceremony of the CISF, Shah said the force has grown from "zero to the pinnacle" in the field of industrial security over the past 56 years, reflecting its dedication, courage and professionalism.

During the event, the Home minister laid the foundation stone for three CISF residential complexes to be built in Kamrup, Nashik and Sehore at a cost



of Rs 890 crore. He also inaugurated two completed residential complexes in Rajarhat and Delhi to improve living facilities for personnel and their families.

Shah said India's vision of becoming a major global economic power cannot be achieved without rapid industrial development, and ensuring security for industries requires

a dedicated national-level force. He added that CISF has consistently adapted to evolving challenges by combining its traditional values with modern technology and weapons.

The Home Minister noted that the CISF currently provides security to 70 airports and 361 vital installations across the country. The force has also been

designated as the nodal agency for drone security and has recently been assigned the protection of several key projects, including Kartavya Bhavan, Seva Teerth, Noida International Airport, Navi Mumbai Airport, Lengpui Airport, the Jawaharpur Thermal Power Project and the Bhakra Dam Project.

Shah said the government is also working on a hybrid model under which CISF will provide security to private industrial groups using modern equipment.

He highlighted the contribution of CISF personnel in strengthening the country's economic security and said the force has received over 13,693 medals for gallantry and distinguished service.

JD(U) workers continue to vent spleen

Day after Nitish filed Rajya Sabha nomination papers

OUR CORRESPONDENT

PATNA: workers on Friday continued to protest the decision of Chief Minister Nitish Kumar to enter the Rajya Sabha, a move seen as signalling the end of his more than two-and-a-half-decade-long stint in Bihar politics.

At the JD(U) office here, situated right across the street from the BJP's state headquarters, irate party workers staged a demonstration alleging that "traitors" had hatched a "conspiracy" with the alliance partner to "get rid of" their leader, who had been an eyesore for the "powerful liquor lobby" ever since he brought prohibition.

"There are some people in our party who are playing the role of Jaichand (12th-century Rajput chieftain who aided Afghan invader Muhammad



JD(U) workers stage a protest against the decision of Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar to enter the Rajya Sabha, in Patna, Friday PFI

Ghori). One is in the Union Cabinet, and the other has come from the BJP and is lord-ing over us now", an irate JD(U) worker alleged.

The allusion was to Union minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh alias Lalan, an old aide of Nitish Kumar and a former party president, and Sanjay Kumar Jha, the JD(U)'s working president, who had

started as a BJP youth wing worker in the 1990s.

Neither Lalan nor Jha has responded to the allegations that have been levelled against them ever since Kumar filed his nomination papers for Rajya Sabha polls on Thursday, minutes after announcing his intent on social media.

JD(U) workers alleged that "the BJP is playing the same trick against Nitish Kumar that it had played against Karpoori Thakur, who faced the ire of the Jan Sangh upon implementation of prohibition. We have learnt that a deal worth crores has been struck between traitors of our party and the BJP. They have been paid heavily by the powerful liquor lobby to get rid of Nitish Kumar, which would pave the way for the scrapping of the ban on liquor."

K'taka CM presents his 17th Budget; alleges injustice by Centre

BENGALURU: Presenting his record 17th Budget on Friday, Karnataka Chief Minister Siddaramaiah said, by not adhering to the federal system of governance as per the constitution, the Centre is doing injustice to Karnataka.

He also said that the state government is pursuing a development strategy that balances welfare programmes with investments in infrastructure and long-term economic transformation, while urging the Union govt to be more sensitive to the state's demands. Presenting the Budget for 2026-27, CM said Karnataka remains at the forefront of the nation's development and is among the largest contributors of tax revenues to the country. MPOST

Kind Attention Rail Passengers									
POST HOLI FESTIVAL SPECIAL TRAINS-2026									
For the convenience of the passengers Railway will run the following Post Holi Special Trains as per following detail :-									
04162 New Delhi - Kanpur Central Unreserved Special Train									01 Trip
STATIONS		TRAIN NO. 04162							
		DEP.		ARR.					
New Delhi		09:30		---					
Kanpur Central		---		17:30					
Days of Run : 04162 Ex. New Delhi on 07.03.2026.									
Accommodation : General.									
Stoppages : Aligarh Jn. and Panki Dham stations.									
04163/04164 Kanpur Central - New Delhi - Kanpur Central Special Train									06 Trips
TRAIN NO. 04163		STATIONS				TRAIN NO. 04164			
ARR.	DEP.					ARR.	DEP.		
---	22:30	Kanpur Central				17:30	---		
07:30	---	New Delhi				---	09:30		
Days of Run : 04163 Ex. Kanpur Central on 07.03.26, 08.03.26 & 09.03.26 and 04164 Ex. New Delhi on 08.03.26, 09.03.26 & 10.03.26									
Accommodation : AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.									
Stoppages : Panki Dham and Aligarh Jn. stations.									
03257/03258 Danapur - Anand Vihar (T) - Danapur Special Train (Weekly)									06 Trips
TRAIN NO. 03257		STATIONS				TRAIN NO. 03258			
ARR.	DEP.					ARR.	DEP.		
---	07:30	Danapur				20:45	---		
00:30	---	Anand Vihar (T)				---	05:00		
Days of Run : 03257 Ex. Danapur on every Sunday from 15.03.2026 to 29.03.2026 and 03258 Ex. Anand Vihar (T) on every Monday from 16.03.2026 to 30.03.2026.									
Accommodation : AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.									
Stoppages : Ara Jn, Buxar, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Jn., Subedarganj and Govindpuri stations.									
05219/05220 Muzaffarpur Jn. - Anand Vihar (T) - Muzaffarpur Jn. Special Train (Weekly)									06 Trips
TRAIN NO. 05219		STATIONS				TRAIN NO. 05220			
ARR.	DEP.					ARR.	DEP.		
---	13:30	Muzaffarpur Jn.				09:45	---		
10:00	---	Anand Vihar (T)				---	12:00		
Days of Run : 05219 Ex. Muzaffarpur Jn. on every Friday from 13.03.2026 to 27.03.2026 and 05220 Ex. Anand Vihar (T) on every Saturday from 14.03.2026 to 28.03.2026.									
Accommodation : AC 2 Tier & AC 3 Tier Economy.									
Stoppages : Hajipur Jn, Sonpur Jn, Patliputra, Danapur, Ara Jn, Buxar, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Jn., Prayagraj Jn. and Govindpuri stations.									
03293/03294 Patna Jn. - New Delhi - Patna Jn. Special Train (Daily)									30 Trips
TRAIN NO. 03293		STATIONS				TRAIN NO. 03294			
ARR.	DEP.					ARR.	DEP.		
---	21:00	Patna Jn.				12:25	---		
12:50	---	New Delhi				---	14:15		
Days of Run : 03293 Ex. Patna Jn. daily from 16.03.2026 to 30.03.2026 and 03294 Ex. New Delhi daily from 17.03.2026 to 31.03.2026.									
Accommodation : AC 3 Tier, AC 3 Tier Economy, Sleeper & General.									
Stoppages : Danapur, Ara Jn, Buxar, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Jn., Subedarganj and Govindpuri stations.									
03639/03640 Dhanbad Jn. - Shakurbasti - Dhanbad Jn. Special Train (Bi-Weekly)									12 Trips
TRAIN NO. 03639		STATIONS				TRAIN NO. 03640			
ARR.	DEP.					ARR.	DEP.		
---	18:30	Dhanbad Jn.				23:45	---		
18:10	---	Shakurbasti				---	21:10		
Days of Run : 03639 Ex. Dhanbad Jn. on every Monday & Friday from 13.03.2026 to 30.03.2026 and 03640 Ex. Shakurbasti on every Tuesday & Saturday from 14.03.2026 to 31.03.2026.									
Accommodation : AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.									
Stoppages : Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose Jn. Gomoh, Parasnath, Hazaribagh Road, Koderma Jn, Gaya Jn, Anugraha Narayan Road, Dehri On Sone, Sasaram, Bhabua Road, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Jn., Prayagraj Jn., Govindpuri and Delhi stations.									
For any kind of information, passengers are requested to contact RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit Indian Railways website https://enquiry.indianrail.gov.in or NTES App.									

03697/03698 Sheikhpura - Anand Vihar (T) - Sheikhpura Special Train (4 Days in Week)						18 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 03697		STATIONS			TRAIN NO. 03698		
ARR.	DEP.				ARR.	DEP.	
---	11:30	Sheikhpura			14:45	---	
11:40	---	Anand Vihar (T)			---	13:30	
Days of Run : 03697 Ex. Sheikhpura on Monday, Tuesday, Friday & Saturday from 16.03.2026 to 30.03.2026 and 03698 Ex. Anand Vihar (T) on Tuesday, Wednesday, Saturday & Sunday from 17.03.2026 to 31.03.2026.							
Accommodation : AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, Sleeper & General.							
Stoppages : Warisale Ganj, Nawadah, Tilaya, Gaya Jn, Anugraha Narayan Road, Dehri On Sone, Sasaram, Bhabua Road, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Jn., Prayagraj Jn., Govindpuri and Tundla Jn stations.							
02397/02398 Sheikhpura - Anand Vihar (T) - Sheikhpura Special Train (Weekly)						04 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 02397		STATIONS			TRAIN NO. 02398		
ARR.	DEP.				ARR.	DEP.	
---	11:30	Sheikhpura			14:45	---	
11:40	---	Anand Vihar (T)			---	13:30	
Days of Run : 02397 Ex. Sheikhpura on every Sunday from 22.03.2026 to 29.03.2026 and 02398 Ex. Anand Vihar (T) on every Monday from 23.03.2026 to 30.03.2026.							
Accommodation : 1st AC, AC 2 Tier, AC 3 Tier, AC 3 Tier Economy, Sleeper & General.							
Stoppages : Warisale Ganj, Nawadah, Tilaya, Gaya Jn, Anugraha Narayan Road, Dehri On Sone, Sasaram, Bhabua Road, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Jn., Prayagraj Jn., Govindpuri and Tundla Jn stations.							
03309/03310 Dhanbad Jn. - Delhi Jn. - Dhanbad Jn. Special Train (Bi-Weekly)						10 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 03309		STATIONS			TRAIN NO. 03310		
ARR.	DEP.				ARR.	DEP.	
---	10:10	Dhanbad Jn.			13:00	---	
18:05	18:15	Varanasi Jn.			03:25	03:35	
09:15	---	Delhi Jn.			---	11:45	
Days of Run : 03309 Ex. Dhanbad Jn. on every Tuesday & Saturday from 14.03.2026 to 28.03.2026 and 03310 Ex. Delhi Jn. on every Wednesday & Sunday from 15.03.2026 to 29.03.2026.							
Accommodation : AC 3 Tier Economy, Sleeper & General.							
Stoppages : Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose Jn, Gomoh, Parasnath, Hazaribagh Road, Koderma Jn, Gaya Jn, Anugraha Narayan Road, Dehri On Sone, Sasaram, Bhabua Road, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Jn., Varanasi Jn., Prayagraj Jn., Govindpuri and Tundla Jn stations.							
05575/05576 Saharsa - Anand Vihar (T) - Saharsa Special Train (Weekly)						04 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 05575		STATIONS			TRAIN NO. 05576		
ARR.	DEP.				ARR.	DEP.	
---	20:00	Saharsa			10:30	---	
18:32	18:34	Bareilly			10:38	10:40	
21:20	21:25	Moradabad			09:05	09:10	
01:05	---	Anand Vihar (T)			---	05:15	
Days of Run : 05575 Ex. Saharsa on every Wednesday from 18.03.2026 to 25.03.2026 and 05576 Ex. Anand Vihar (T) on every Tuesday from 24.03.2026 to 31.03.2026.							
Accommodation : AC 3 Tier Economy, Sleeper & General.							
Stoppages : Garh Baruari, Supaul, Saraygarh, Nirmali, Ghogardiha, Jhanjharpur, Sakri Jn, Shisho, Janakpur Road, Sitamari, Baigania, Raxaul Jn, Narkatiganj Jn, Bagaha, Kaptanganj Jn, Gorakhpur Jn, Basti, Gonda Jn, Sitapur, Shahjahanpur, Bareilly, Moradabad, Hapur and Ghaziabad stations.							
05579/05580 Purnia Court - Anand Vihar (T) - Purnia Court Special Train (3 Days in Week)						12 Trips	
TRAIN NO. 05579		STATIONS			TRAIN NO. 05580		
ARR.	DEP.				ARR.	DEP.	
---	16:30	Purnia Court			13:45	---	
18:32	18:34	Bareilly			10:38	10:40	
21:20	21:25	Moradabad			09:05	09:10	
01:05	---	Anand Vihar (T)			---	05:15	
Days of Run : 05579 Ex. Purnia Court on Tuesday, Friday & Sunday from 17.03.2026 to 29.03.2026 and 05580 Ex. Anand Vihar (T) on Thursday, Friday & Sunday from 19.03.2026 to 29.03.2026.							
Accommodation : AC 3 Tier Economy, Sleeper & General.							
Stoppages : Banmankhi Jn, Murliganj, Dauram Madhpura, Saharsa Jn, Garh Baruari, Supaul, Saraygarh, Nirmali, Ghogardiha, Jhanjharpur, Sakri Jn, Shisho, Janakpur Road, Sitamari, Baigania, Raxaul Jn, Narkatiganj Jn, Bagaha, Kaptanganj Jn, Gorakhpur Jn, Basti, Gonda Jn, Sitapur, Shahjahanpur, Bareilly, Moradabad, Hapur and Ghaziabad stations.							
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US LAUNCHED MILITARY STRIKES ON IRAN ON FEBRUARY 28

Middle East crisis ‘highly unusual’, could hit global economy: Rajnath

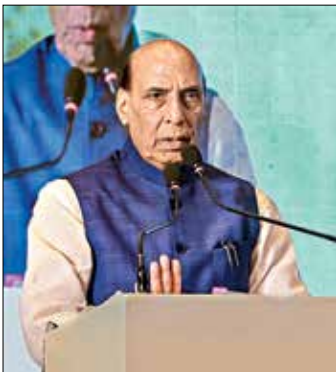
OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In this era of changing geopolitics, oceans have once again come to the centre of the world's power balance and it is India's responsibility to provide leadership with confidence and capability, Defence minister Rajnath Singh said on Friday, referring to the escalating conflict in the Middle East.

The unfolding developments in the Middle East is "highly unusual" and the situation in the region could adversely impact the global economy, he said addressing an event in Kolkata.

"What is happening there is quite unusual. It is difficult to make concrete comments about the future course of events in the Middle East or in our neighbourhood. The Strait of Hormuz or the entire Persian Gulf region is crucial for global energy security," Singh said.

"When there is disturbance



Defence minister Rajnath Singh addresses a gathering at the inauguration of 'Sagar Sankalp - Reclaiming India's Maritime Glory', a defence and maritime dialogue, in Kolkata

oil and LNG (Liquefied Natural Gas). Singh said the current situation in the Middle East has once again reflected the importance of oceans.

"In this era of changing global geopolitics, oceans have once again come to the center of the world's power balance. At such a time, as a major maritime nation, it is India's responsibility to provide leadership with confidence, capability, and a clear vision," he said.

The defence minister, however, did not make any direct or indirect reference to the US sinking an Iranian warship off the coast of Sri Lanka two days ago.

The Iranian frigate, IRIS Dena, was returning home after participating in the Milan multilateral naval exercise hosted by India. At least 87 Iranian sailors were killed in the attack, which marked a major escalation in the conflict between the US and Iran outside of the Persian Gulf.

Key Points

- » Singh said the current situation in the Middle East has once again reflected the importance of oceans
- » The global scenario is an abnormal situation, said defence minister

in the region, it directly impacts the supply of oil and gas. Moreover, we're witnessing supply chain disruptions in other sectors as well. These uncertainties have a direct impact on the economy and global trade," he said.

"The global scenario is an abnormal situation. What is

more worrying is the fact that this abnormality is becoming the new normal," he added.

Global oil and gas prices have surged after Iran has virtually blocked the Strait of Hormuz, a narrow shipping lane between the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman, that handles roughly 20 per cent of global

UP: Rumours of fuel crisis due to West Asia conflict spark panic

Long queues seen at petrol pumps

OUR CORRESPONDENT

LAKHIMPUR KHERI: Rumours about a shortage of petroleum products and liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) due to the ongoing West Asia conflict triggered panic among locals in several areas of Lakhimpur Kheri here, leading to long queues at many petrol pumps on Friday, officials said.

Queues of people seeking to purchase petrol and diesel were witnessed across several fuel stations in the Nighasan, Pallia and Bhira areas amid fears of a possible shortage.

However, District Supply Officer Anjani Kumar Singh dismissed the rumours as baseless and said there was no shortage of petrol, diesel or LPG in the district.

"The rumours of shortage of petrol, diesel or LPG in Kheri district are baseless and unfounded," Singh told the news agency, adding that adequate stocks of petroleum products were available and people should purchase them only as per their needs.

He also warned of strict action against anyone found hoarding petroleum products.

District Magistrate Durga Shakti Nagpal also took cognisance of the rumours and appealed to people not to panic, assuring that the supply of petrol and diesel in the district was normal.

Kheri Petroleum Traders Association district president Abhishek Dixit emphasised

Closer Look

» Queues of people seeking to purchase fuel were witnessed across several fuel stations in Nighasan, Pallia and Bhira areas

» District Magistrate Durga Shakti Nagpal also took cognisance of rumours and appealed to people not to panic

that there was no fuel crisis in the district and sufficient stock was available at petrol pumps to meet consumer demand. Similarly, Arun Kumar Singh, district president of the LPG distributors association, said there was adequate LPG stock in the district and urged residents not to panic.

The administration in Barabanki district also dismissed rumours of a fuel shortage circulating on social media and other platforms, with District Magistrate Shashank Tripathi saying the claims about a shortage of petrol and diesel are baseless and misleading.

Tripathi said that adequate stocks of petrol and diesel were available at all fuel stations in the district, and the supply system was functioning normally.

The administration was continuously monitoring the situation at petrol pumps, and there was no shortage of fuel anywhere, he said.

Officials should encourage farmers to cultivate medicinal and aromatic plants: CM Saini

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini said that officers should encourage farmers in the state to cultivate medicinal and aromatic plants so that they can earn higher income even from limited agricultural land.

He also directed officials to create awareness among farmers about conserving water by promoting micro-irrigation.

Saini was speaking on Friday while releasing the "Report of Working Group on Promotion of Medicinal and Aromatic Plants in Haryana" and the "Report of Working Group on Promotion of Micro Irrigation in Haryana" of the Haryana Kisan Kalyan Pradhikaran.



Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini greeting Punjab Governor Gulab Chand Kataria at his residence Sant Kabir Kutir in Chandigarh

On this occasion, the Chief Minister also chaired a meeting regarding the price policy determination for Kharif crops (marketing season 2026-27) and

directed that a proposal in this regard be prepared and sent to the Central government.

Those present in the meeting included Chief Secretary Anurag Rastogi, Principal Secretary, Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare Department, Pankaj Agarwal, Additional Principal Secretary to the Chief Minister, Saket Kumar, Director, Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare Department, Rajnarayan Kaushik, Chief Executive Officer of Haryana Kisan Kalyan Pradhikaran, Ravinder Singh Chauhan, Additional Chief Executive Officer Hitesh Kumar Meena, and other officers.

The CM said that India is among the world's largest exporters of medicinal herbs and Haryana can also make an

important contribution in this sector due to its strategic location and strong agricultural infrastructure.

He said that if medicinal and aromatic plants are promoted in a sustainable and well-planned manner in the state, the sector can create significant economic opportunities for farmers and entrepreneurs.

He said that the medicinal and aromatic plants sector is not limited only to cultivation, but also includes activities such as processing, extraction, manufacturing of value-added products and marketing. Therefore, this sector can create new employment opportunities in rural areas and play an important role in strengthening the local economy.



Indian passengers arrive on a flight from Saudi Arabia, amid the ongoing Iran-Israel conflict, at Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel International Airport, in Ahmedabad, Gujarat

For March 6, 2026, Indian carriers have planned to operate 51 flights from the West Asian region

operational feasibility and the prevailing conditions.

The Ministry of Civil Aviation is in close touch with the airlines and is closely monitoring the airfares to ensure that there is no surge in the air

ticket prices during this time. The officials at the Ministry of Civil Aviation stated that the Ministry is closely coordinating with the airlines to ensure the smooth movement of the passengers during this time.

The passengers are advised to keep in touch with their respective airlines for the latest information regarding the flights.

The Ministry will issue updates based on the evolving situation in the region, the officials added.

UPSC 2025

BJP leader's son Ekansh Dhull secures 3rd rank

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Bhartiya Janta Party (BJP) leader Krishan Dhull's son Akansh Dhull secured third rank in Union Public Service Commission (UPSC).

It was a moment of joy for the entire family. Akansh Dhull, a resident of Panchkula, lives in Sector 12A.

His mother, Nirmala, is a school principal. His father, Krishna Dhull, a senior BJP leader.

He secured the 342nd rank in the Union Public Service Commission in 2024 and the

295th rank in 2025.

Now, for the third time, he has cracked the exam and secured a top-3 rank.

He is in Shimla on training presently.

"After the results were declared, Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini called Akansh's father, Krishna Dhull, and congratulated him on his son's third rank.

Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini also extended his heartfelt congratulations and best wishes to all candidates who succeeded in the Civil Services Examination, the results of which were declared by the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC).

Chromium found in blood of residents along Ganga in UP's Kanpur & Unnao

Raising serious health concerns in the region

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: Residents living along the banks of the Ganga in Kanpur and neighbouring Unnao district have been found to carry toxic chromium in their blood, raising alarm over the long term impact of industrial pollution linked to the tannery belt in the region.

A fresh medical report submitted before the National Green Tribunal has revealed that chromium levels above the permissible limit were detected in the blood samples of a large number of residents living in pollution affected areas near Kanpur's leather processing

hub. The laboratory investigation was carried out by the Department of Biochemistry at the Dr Ram Manohar Lohia Institute of Medical Sciences in Lucknow.

The findings were submitted as part of an affidavit filed by the Kanpur Nagar district administration in an ongoing case related to industrial pollution from tanneries in the Jajmau area.

According to the affidavit, 233 blood samples collected from residents of affected localities were tested and chromium was detected in 215 of them.

In addition, four samples

showed traces of mercury while 10 people were found to have lead in their blood.

Health officials said the samples were collected in January from residents of Jajmau and Ruma areas of Kanpur, where several settlements lie close to drains carrying industrial waste from the tannery cluster.

While 586 people were tested, reports of only 233 samples have been released so far and results of the remaining 353 samples are still awaited.

Government data submitted earlier before the tribunal had also indicated widespread exposure to chromium in the region.

Sarpanch shot dead in Punjab's Moga

CHANDIGARH: A village sarpanch was shot dead by four to five assailants in broad daylight in Punjab's Moga district on Friday, police said.

Harpinder Singh alias Happy, sarpanch of Patto Hira Singh village, was attacked on the Baghapurana-Kotkapura road over suspected personal rivalry, police said.

Singh had gone to his gym and when he stepped out of his car, the assailants, who came in an SUV, fired 10-12 rounds at him. He was rushed to the hospital, where he died, they said.

Moga Senior Superintendent of Police (SSP) Ajay Gandhi, who visited the spot, said personal rivalry appeared to be the reason behind the killing and ruled out the involvement of any gangster.

Those behind the firing have been identified. Further investigation is underway, he said. "We have gathered some clues. All our teams are on the job and the accused will be nabbed soon," the SSP said.

Women's representation in legislatures: Numbers rise, parity remains distant

Currently, women make up about 14 per cent of the Lok Sabha members

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: Despite decades of progress, women remain underrepresented in India's Parliament and state legislatures, highlighting a significant gap between aspiration and reality.

As the Budget Session begins on March 9, the spotlight returns to women's participation in the nation's law-making bodies.

Currently, women make up about 14 per cent of the Lok Sabha members—a notable increase but still far below the global average of 27 per cent, according to the Inter-Parliamentary Union. Since nearly half of India's population is female, this underrepresentation questions the true inclusiveness of our democracy.

The disparity isn't uniform across parties. The Trinamool Congress stands out with over 35 per cent women representatives, the highest among parties in both Houses. In contrast, major parties like the Bharatiya



Janata Party and the Indian National Congress each have only about 15 per cent women members.

Historically, the number of women in Parliament has been modest. Until the late 1990s, women occupied just 4 to 8 per cent of Lok Sabha seats. While numbers gradually grew—thanks to shifting politi-

cal ideals and stronger women's movements—they remain a small minority.

At the state level, the picture is similar. Women occupy roughly 10 per cent of legislative seats nationwide, with some states like Chhattisgarh pushing higher to around 20 per cent. Party-wise, women's representation hovers around

HIGHLIGHTS

» The Trinamool Congress stands out with over 35 per cent women representatives, the highest among parties in both Houses

» In contrast, major parties like the Bharatiya Janata Party and the Indian National Congress each have only about 15 per cent women members

» Women's leadership roles are equally limited

10 per cent, though parties like Trinamool Congress and Telugu Desam Party have slightly higher figures.

Women's leadership roles are equally limited. Since 1952, only two women have served as Lok Sabha Speaker, and none have held the position of Deputy Speaker. Globally, women are poised to constitute about

16 per cent of legislative presiding officers by 2026—a modest increase, but one that still leaves much room for growth.

Despite the low numbers, women lawmakers are remarkably active.

In the 18th Lok Sabha, their participation matched their male colleagues—attending 85 per cent of sittings, raising questions, and engaging in debates. Their active engagement underscores the vital role women play in shaping policies.

As the upcoming Budget Session unfolds, discussions on government expenditure will once again bring lawmakers together. While economic issues dominate, the persistent underrepresentation of women remains a critical issue for India's democracy.

True democracy thrives when the parliament truly reflects the society it serves. Though progress has been slow, the journey toward a more inclusive, representative democracy continues, one step at a time.

India granted emergency docking to Iranian naval ship in Kochi: Sources

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Days before the US torpedoed and sank Iranian frigate IRIS Dena, India approved urgent docking for another Iranian naval vessel in Kochi after it developed a technical glitch, government sources said on Friday.

The vessel, docked in Kochi on March 4 with its 183 crew members, is being accommodated at Indian naval facilities on humanitarian grounds, they said. The ship IRIS Lavan developed urgent technical issues and was granted emergency docking approval on March 1 following a request from the Iranian side, the sources said.

India was approached by the Iranian side days before IRIS Dena was sunk by a US submarine off the coast of Sri Lanka.

IRIS Dena was returning home after participating in the Milan multilateral naval exercise hosted by India. At least 87 Iranian sailors were killed in the attack on Wednesday.

Days before the IRIS Dena incident south of Sri Lanka,

India was approached by Iran to take in the Iranian ship IRIS Lavan which was also in the region for the International Fleet Review, the sources said.

This request was received on February 28 indicating that a docking at Kochi was urgent as the vessel had developed technical issues, they said.

The approval was accorded for the docking of the ship on March 1. IRIS Lavan has since docked at Kochi on March 4, the sources said.

In this context, its crew of 183 are currently accommodated at naval facilities in Kochi, they said.

India's granting of emergency harbour to another Iranian naval vessel came to light against the backdrop of increasing spotlight on the US strike on IRIS Dena.

Iran has reacted sharply to the sinking of the ship.

"IRIS Dena was a training ship. It was invited by the Indian Navy to take part in an exercise. They went there as guests. They were unarmed," Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said.



EDITORIAL
STRATEGIC
OIL
CALCULUS

The Strait of Hormuz has long been described as the world's most critical energy chokepoint, but its strategic importance becomes fully visible only when it stops functioning. The recent disruption of maritime cargo movement through the narrow passage between Iran and Oman has exposed how deeply the global energy system depends on this fragile artery. For India, which sources more than 40 per cent of its crude oil imports through this route, the impact has been immediate and unsettling. Tankers carrying oil from Iraq, Saudi Arabia, Kuwait and the United Arab Emirates—countries that form the backbone of India's energy supply—normally pass through the strait in steady streams. When that flow falters, the consequences ripple quickly across refineries, markets and diplomatic corridors. In this volatile setting, the United States has issued a temporary 30-day waiver allowing Indian refiners to purchase Russian crude that is already afloat in tankers. The move is not merely a logistical adjustment; it is a reminder of how geopolitical crises can overturn carefully negotiated trade arrangements overnight.

India's energy vulnerability is rooted in its dependence on imported crude. As the world's third-largest oil importer, the country relies on overseas supplies for nearly 88 per cent of its crude consumption. Of the roughly five million barrels of oil India imports daily, about half typically arrives through the Strait of Hormuz. This means that even a partial disruption can create anxiety across the energy ecosystem. Over the past two years, India has increasingly diversified its supply sources, with Russian oil emerging as a major contributor after Western sanctions on Moscow pushed discounted crude into Asian markets. At its peak in 2024 and 2025, Russian oil accounted for more than two million barrels per day of India's imports, making Moscow the country's largest supplier. Yet recent trade negotiations with Washington, including pressure linked to a proposed 25 per cent tariff on Indian exports, had compelled New Delhi to scale back those purchases. Imports from Russia fell sharply earlier this year, reflecting the delicate balancing act India performs between strategic autonomy and geopolitical partnerships.

The disruption in the Gulf has now forced a recalibration. With Hormuz traffic constrained and Middle Eastern supplies uncertain, Indian refiners have begun tapping floating stocks of Russian crude already moving across international waters. Commodity tracking firms estimate that roughly 130 million barrels of oil are currently stored in tankers across the Indian Ocean, Red Sea and Asian maritime routes, a portion of which can be redirected toward Indian ports. Trade sources suggest that more than 15 million barrels of Russian crude are already near Indian waters in the Arabian Sea and Bay of Bengal, with another seven million barrels located around Singapore. These cargoes can reach Indian refineries within days, offering a short-term buffer against supply disruptions. Yet this stopgap solution cannot fully replace the steady volumes that normally arrive from West Asia. Moreover, competition from Chinese buyers—who are also eager to secure Russian supplies—could push prices higher, eroding the discounts that once made Russian oil attractive.

The American decision to grant India a temporary waiver must also be viewed through the lens of domestic politics in Washington. President Donald Trump's administration has repeatedly emphasised the importance of low energy prices as a cornerstone of its economic agenda. Rising global oil prices would translate directly into higher gasoline costs for American consumers, a politically sensitive issue in a year marked by midterm elections. By allowing India to purchase Russian oil already at sea, the US Treasury hopes to maintain global supply levels and prevent a sharp price spike. The waiver is deliberately limited in scope—restricted to oil already loaded onto ships—to ensure that it does not significantly boost Russia's revenues. Yet the move reveals the flexibility that geopolitical realities often impose on sanctions regimes. When energy markets tighten, strategic pragmatism tends to prevail over rigid policy lines.

For India, the episode underscores the urgency of strengthening energy resilience. The country has made progress in diversifying its import sources and expanding strategic petroleum reserves, but structural vulnerabilities remain. Global oil demand continues to rise, even as the energy transition gathers momentum. Until renewable energy and alternative fuels scale up substantially, crude oil will remain central to India's economic growth and industrial activity. This means New Delhi must continue to pursue a multi-pronged strategy: broadening its supplier base, investing in storage capacity, deepening diplomatic engagement with energy producers, and accelerating domestic renewable energy programmes. The Strait of Hormuz crisis is a stark reminder that energy security cannot be taken for granted. In an era where geopolitics increasingly shapes commodity flows, resilience lies not in dependence on a single supplier or route, but in the ability to adapt swiftly when the global order shifts.

GOVERNANCE
WATCH



ALOK RANJAN

THE WRITER IS A FORMER IAS OFFICER WHO SERVED AS THE CHIEF SECRETARY, GOVT OF UTTAR PRADESH

While the initiative seeks greater accountability, it also raises important questions about how leadership and governance should truly be evaluated

Grading India's Top Bureaucrats

The Cabinet Secretariat's new performance scorecards for Union Secretaries aim to improve accountability, but measuring governance requires more than numerical indicators

We all remember our school days when the annual report card was a much-awaited event and we used to approach the appointed day with much trepidation and expectation. The report card had the potential of giving you great joy and uplifting your spirits sky high or putting you down in the dumps. Those who put in years of hard labour throughout their academic career and qualified for the haloed civil services must have heaved a sigh of relief that they have now gone beyond the report card stage. But now they would be dismayed to find the Cabinet Secretary to the Government of India evaluating performance on a periodical basis and giving them their report cards indicating the marks that they have scored out of hundred. This is happening at the level of Union Secretaries, and one can imagine them comparing their marks with each other just like in the childhood days.

From what I gathered from newspapers, it appears that the Cabinet Secretariat has issued administrative scorecards to Secretaries to the Central Government showing the percentage of marks obtained by them based on their individual performance as well as that of their departments. The assessment scheme is that the Secretaries and their departments would be graded on about a dozen parameters with a total of hundred marks, which include negative marks and discretionary marks to be awarded by the Cabinet Secretary. File disposal is given the highest prominence with a maximum of 20 marks. Fifteen marks are for expenditure on schemes and capital expenditure, and fifteen marks for monthly output in relation to decided parameters. Public grievance redressal carries five marks, while there are marks for Cabinet notes, litigation, timely completion of high-



Union Secretaries are now assessed through a performance evaluation system based on multiple administrative indicators

value projects and financial advice. It is interesting that the scorecard also carries twelve marks which would be like a penalty imposed for excessive expenditure on foreign tours or events, abnormal pendency of files at the level of Secretary, and delayed payments to micro, small and medium enterprises.

The Cabinet Secretary has five discretionary marks at his disposal which he would award for exceptional work or special contribution made. Quite obviously, the purpose of this exercise is to evolve a system which would constantly evaluate the efficiency and working of Secretaries of their departments based, as far as possible, on an objective and fair methodology. It is true that a large portion of the work being done by Union Secretaries and their team of officers is difficult to quantify and the subjective element cannot completely be ruled out. However, the logic used by the Cabinet Secretary cannot be faulted when he says that it does not mean that if something cannot be measured with perfect accuracy it should not be measured at

all. He asserts that different departments face situations which are unique to them, but still a feedback mechanism is possible. In management, the principle followed is that whatever can be measured will get done. This exercise is attempting to measure performance indicators and is a welcome step. This evaluation is in addition to the monthly demi-official letter written by Secretaries to the Cabinet Secretary outlining the performance done by them during the course of the month.

The performance evaluation in government currently is done at the end of the year and is more like a post-mortem. It helps to evaluate an officer for promotion purposes but does not contribute to identifying areas of improvement during the year. Concurrent evaluation at periodic intervals is more likely to give results than a once-in-a-year evaluation. There is no denying that the job of a public servant goes far beyond achieving quantitative targets, as there are a multiplicity of objectives that she must fulfil. A large number of such parameters are sub-

jective in nature but of great importance. An example of this would be the attitude of the civil servant towards the weaker sections of society. With a little bit of application, indicators or metrics of such social objectives can also be enumerated and evaluated. I notice that in this report card, results and outcomes are also being given some weightage, which is how it should be.

Public service delivery is dependent upon actual performance at the field level. To achieve this, the Cabinet Secretariat would have to do a deeper exercise of evaluation rather than just assess the data provided. The capacity to take initiative, creativity, problem-solving approach, innovativeness, and providing a long-term vision to the department are essential qualities on which the Secretary as a leader should be assessed. I am not so sure whether the parameters laid down provide an indication of these leadership qualities. A Secretary brings with her the experience of more than three decades of public service, and we would not like to have a system which restrains him to focus only on

routine and urgent matters and not allow her to express herself fully, giving the department the benefit of her unique style of leadership. We need parameters to judge the leadership capability of a Secretary and other senior officers.

Besides, sometimes things like speed of file disposal can be misleading. An officer can clear her desk by simply raising unwanted queries or referring the file for legal or financial advice. She could also evade taking responsibility by pushing the file upwards for directions or, like a true bureaucrat, resort to the time-honoured practice of setting up committees. It is decisions that we want from our leaders and not merely the talent to navigate the process by keeping the file in endless movement. I recall a senior Secretary of mine telling me that he knew how to send a file into orbit where it would continue in a circular motion till he decided to bring it back. Effective governance requires prompt decision-making, a visionary approach, coordination, and the ability to develop a team which can give results. Another strong quality that a leader must possess is the ability to dismantle red tape and bring in a culture of deregulation and decentralisation. All this calls for a more elaborate and scientific system of performance evaluation. Along with parameters that can be subjected to quantitative evaluation, the subjective qualities of leadership also need to be given due weightage in evaluating senior officers of the Government.

The above does not in any way diminish the value of what the Cabinet Secretary has proposed. My only view is that various other parameters are important if we want to assess the performance of a leader. Serious consideration must be given to this to make the evaluation process more effective and outcome-oriented.

Views expressed are personal

The money gap

On the eve of International Women's Day, a sobering reality is that women entrepreneurs in India are still struggling and fighting to access credit and financial assistance

A man and woman walk into a bank. The man walks out with a business loan, the woman walks out with trauma. This is not a joke because the lack of credit access for women entrepreneurs is not a laughing matter. In spite of several programmes, government initiatives, and bank schemes, women entrepreneurs continue to face a deeply skewed reality. I can tell from personal experience that none of the obstacles that we hear about are hyperboles. These are real situations where dynamic, deserving women have been denied funds. Obviously, some of these superhumans have found ways to fight the bias and move the needle in their favour. But they have strived and struggled to do so; several others have thrown in the towel or have been swallowed by market and global uncertainties. The truth is that it should not have to be so damn difficult.

Typically, when a woman entrepreneur approaches a bank for working capital or even an overdraft facility, she will be first asked for her husband's name (or any other male partner), a sole proprietorship will be viewed with suspicion followed by demands for a guarantor (who must almost always be male) will be put forth. As outlined in a recent LinkedIn live session that I conducted with an MSME (micro, small, and medium enterprises) expert, women entrepreneurs are also more likely to be asked for collateral than men. And given that women rarely have properties in their name, their search for capital ends right there.

This is in spite of the fact that a whopping 94 per cent of women repay loans on time. Our repayment rates may be high, but the gender bias is still rocketing. Women-led MSMEs comprise 20 per cent of all MSMEs in India. Even as we claim to encourage more female participation, women businesses encounter prejudice at every step of the way.



From collateral requirements to implicit gender bias, the financial system continues to place disproportionate hurdles before women seeking capital

As per Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI), women experience a 35 per cent credit gap as compared to 20 per cent faced by men.

It's well-documented that women MSMEs have to jump through hoops for the same benefits that are doled out to their male counterparts. Reports suggest that 79 per cent of women-led businesses are self-funded, primarily because enterprising women have little other choice. Even where support schemes exist, the sectors covered are not expansive. News reports suggest that under the decade-old Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY) in 2024, women held 42,492,281 loan accounts out of a total of 66,777,013, highlighting their desire for financial assistance. However, of the Rs 5,41,012.86 crore earmarked for that year's target, only Rs 2,25,887.08 crore was extended to women entrepreneurs.

According to the International Finance Corporation (IFC), a man gets a loan sanctioned within an average of two bank visits, for a woman, it takes double the number of visits. When I tried to expand my business, my first port of call was my banker of 10 years. In spite of my strong relationship with the bank, I

was asked for a husband/male partner/guarantor. Unlike most women, I had collateral to offer, and yet they asked me for "comfort", coercing me into taking a hefty insurance in spite of my multiple current insurance policies. I felt so betrayed and frustrated that I decided to sever ties with the bank. The new bank, though less biased, had inscrutably high levels of scrutiny. If only they put wilful defaulters through the same telescopic lens!

Women-led MSMEs are not the only ones receiving a raw deal; female-led startups are faring no better. A recently released report by Kalaari Capital highlights that for every Rs 100 raised by male founders, women founders get a mere Rs 4! There are more women enrolling for STEM (science, technology, engineering, and mathematics) education but just not enough women at the top of the corporate chain, not many writing cheques, and in spite of an influential Indian startup ecosystem, the ground scene still pinches. So, we may wish each other "happy women's day" and pat ourselves on what we have achieved, but the journey ahead remains bumpy, tremulous, and starkly unfair.

Views expressed are personal

AT
VANTAGE



SHUTAPA PAUL

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND MEDIA ENTREPRENEUR

Despite strong repayment records and growing entrepreneurship, women in India still face deep structural bias when seeking credit from banks and financial institutions

WHO SAID
WHAT



When the United States decides to allow India to purchase Russian oil for just 30 days, it raises a fundamental question. Why should India need another country's approval to secure its own energy needs? Equally troubling is the sinking of the unarmed Iranian warship IRIS Dena by the United States soon after it participated in the International Fleet Review 2026 naval exercise hosted by India in Visakhapatnam. When a ship that came to India as part of a multinational exercise meets such a fate, India cannot appear silent or passive. The Union BJP Government looks totally compromised on India's long standing tradition of strategic autonomy and an independent foreign policy. India's dignity in the international arena needs to be protected and the nation's sovereignty and interests need to be defended.



NEPAL ELECTIONS

RSP set for landslide victory, Balendra Shah likely next PM

KATHMANDU: Rapper-turned-politician Balendra Shah's newly formed Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP) was on Friday heading towards a sweeping victory in Nepal's first general elections since the violent Gen Z protests, shattering the dominance of established political parties in the politically fragile nation.

According to the Election Commission's data available from 144 of the total 165 constituencies, the RSP has won three seats and is ahead in 104 others, local media reported.

Balendra Shah, who was the Mayor of Kathmandu till recently, is leading in Jhapa-5 constituency against four-time prime minister and CPN-UML chair K P Sharma Oli in the latter's stronghold. Shah, popularly known as Balen, received 6,551 votes, while Oli got just 1,428 votes.

Popularly known as 'Balen',



Rastriya Swatantra Party's (RSP) prime ministerial candidate Balendra Shah 'Balen' and party President Rabi Lamichhane during a rally PTI/FILE PHOTO

the 35-year-old engineer is expected to be the next prime minister of Nepal, reflecting a public mood of rejection of established parties. Nepal has had 14 governments in the last 18 years. The election was closely watched by India, which hopes for a stable gov-

ernment in the politically fragile Himalayan nation to take forward the developmental partnership between the two sides. "We look forward to working with the new Government of Nepal to further build on the robust multifaceted ties between our two countries and

Highlights

- » hah, popularly known as Balen, received 6,551 votes, while Oli got just 1,428 votes
- » The Nepali Congress has won two seats and is leading in 13 others

SHAH WAS ALSO POPULARLY KNOWN AS 'BALEN'

peoples for mutual benefit," Ministry of External Affairs Spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said in Delhi on Thursday.

He said India has "consistently supported peace, progress and stability in Nepal and in keeping with our commitment, provided logistical supplies as per request from Government of Nepal for these elections". The Nepali Con-

gress has won two seats and is leading in 13 others, while the CPN-UML is leading in 10 constituencies. The Nepali Communist Party has won one and is leading in six constituencies. The Shram Sanskriti Party is leading in six constituencies. Out of a total of 275 members of the Parliament, 165 will be elected through direct voting, while the remaining 110 will be elected through a proportionate method.

Balen was a popular choice to lead the interim government after Gen Z youths toppled the Oli-led coalition government in September last year, following two days of nationwide violent protests against corruption and a ban on social media.

But Balen declined to lead the interim administration, saying he would rather head the government by contesting the parliamentary election for a full term.

AGENCIES

'Over 520 Afghan Taliban killed by Pakistan forces'

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan's offensive against Afghanistan was going on as the tally of the killed Afghan Taliban operatives reached 527, according to the official on Friday.

Pakistan launched 'Operation Ghazab lil Haq' last week after the Afghan Taliban forces attacked 53 locations along the more than 2,600 kms long border.

Information Minister Attaullah Tarar shared the updates on the Operation Ghazab lil Haq.

Tarar in a post on X also said that 755 Afghan Taliban had also been injured in the operation, while their 237 check-posts had been destroyed, and 38 posts had been captured and subsequently destroyed.

He further said that 205 tanks, armoured vehicles and artillery guns of the Afghan side were also destroyed while 62 locations across Afghanistan were "effectively targeted by air".

The state-run PTV reported citing security sources that armed forces had destroyed terrorist hideouts adjacent to the border in the Zhob and Qila Saifullah sectors, while the Afghan Taliban were forced to abandon their posts and flee.

AGENCIES

Japan, Canada sign strategic agreement in defence & energy

TOKYO: Japan and Canada signed a strategic agreement Friday aimed at strengthening cooperation in defense, economic and energy security as military strikes on Iran by the United States and Israel fueled concern about international oil supplies.

Japan's Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi and her Canadian counterpart Mark Carney shared the importance of energy security at a time of "geopolitical uncertainty," according to a statement by the Japanese Foreign Ministry.

During the talks in Tokyo, the two leaders agreed to work together to diversify energy resources and expand trade and investment to support energy supply chains, according to the road map released by the ministry.

"The world is at a turning point. We see the manifestations in the Middle East. We see it everywhere," Carney told a joint news conference.

Carney's first visit to Japan since taking office last year took place as the war in the Middle

Key Points

- » It is Canadian PM's first visit to Japan since taking office last year
- » This comes amid te war in the Middle East fuels concern about crude oil shipments that travel through Strait of Hormuz in Iran
- » Japan and Canada will start negotiations aimed at achieving a defense pact

East fuels concern about crude oil shipments that travel through Strait of Hormuz in Iran. In Australia earlier this week, Carney called for de-escalation of the Iran war.

Carney and Takaichi also agreed to launch bilateral dialogues on economic security and cyber policies as the two countries face China's growing assertiveness in trade and military activity in the Indo-Pacific.

AGENCIES

Mojtaba Khamenei, presumed next supreme leader of Iran?

Mojtaba Khamenei is a cleric who has spent most of his career outside public office but close to power, working within the Office of the Supreme Leader

BATHUSRT: The death of Iran's supreme leader, Ali Khamenei, during the holy month of Ramadan marks one of the most consequential turning points in the history of the Islamic Republic of Iran.

His successor, widely expected to be his son Mojtaba Khamenei, represents both continuity and contradiction in the revolutionary system established after the Iranian Revolution in 1979.

At stake is not only who leads Iran, but what the Islamic Republic has become, nearly half a century after the revolution that promised an end to dynastic rule.

Who is Mojtaba Khamenei?

Mojtaba Khamenei is a cleric who has spent most of his career outside public office but close to power, working within the Office of the Supreme Leader. He was often seen as a gatekeeper and powerbroker rather than a public political figure with a formal portfolio.

At 17, he briefly served in the Iran-Iraq war. He only began attracting public attention in the late 1990s, by which time his father's authority as supreme leader was firmly established.

Over time, his reputation has centred on two key features. The first is a close relationship with Iran's security establishment, particularly the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps



Mojtaba Khamenei, son of Ali Khamenei who was martyred in Israeli strike

Takeaways

- » At 17, he briefly served in the Iran-Iraq war
- » Iran's constitution dictates that the Assembly of Experts selects the supreme leaders
- » In 2019, the first Trump administration sanctioned Mojtaba

(IRGC), and its hardline networks. The second is a strong opposition to reformist politics and Western engagement.

Critics have linked him to the suppression of protests following the disputed 2009 presidential election. He is also believed to have wielded influence over Iran's state broadcasting organisation, giving him indirect control over parts of

the country's information landscape and state narrative.

In 2019, the first Trump administration sanctioned Mojtaba, accusing him of acting in an official capacity on behalf of the supreme leader despite holding no formal government position.

Mojtaba's legitimacy as leader

Iran's constitution dictates

that the Assembly of Experts (an 88-member clerical body) selects the supreme leader.

The assembly lists the religious, political and leadership qualifications of possible candidates. But in practice, it is not a neutral electoral body. Candidates for the assembly itself are vetted through institutions ultimately shaped by the supreme leader's orbit, and its deliberations are opaque.

This creates a familiar Iranian scenario – the constitution supplies the choreography, while the security-clerical establishment supplies the music. That matters when assessing why Mojtaba is seen as a viable supreme leader amid critiques he lacks the

senior religious standing traditionally associated with the office. A mid-ranking cleric, he was only given the title ayatollah in 2022. The title is necessary to become supreme leader, so the promotion signalled he was being groomed to take over from his ageing and ill father.

The revolution's founding myth was clearly anti-dynastic. After toppling the shah, the revolution's leaders rejected hereditary rule.

To many Iranians, a son following his father as supreme leader looks like an ideological backlash.

The regime appears more like a theocratic monarchy, less the famous "guardianship of the jurist".

Yet, it is also important to be precise. Mojtaba cannot inherit the position by bloodline alone. The assembly must select him.

Still, political systems can become dynastic without rewriting constitutions. Dynastic outcomes emerge when informal power networks, such as family ties, political patronage, security ties, and control over the media, can make one candidate appear more natural, safe or inevitable.

That has essentially been the Mojtaba story in Iran for years: a man who built influence not by winning elections, but by managing the gate to the most powerful office in the country.

AGENCIES

Business

Govt invokes ESMA powers, orders refiners to ramp up LPG production

While India has surplus oil refining capacity, it is short in LPG output

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government invoked sparingly used emergency powers to direct oil refineries to ramp up LPG production as it looks to increase the availability of domestic cooking gas to hedge against potential disruptions from the widening Middle East conflict.

India consumed 31.3 million tonnes of LPG in 2024-25, of which only 12.8 million tonnes were produced domestically, with the remainder imported. Imports have become increasingly vulnerable as 85-90 per cent come from countries like Saudi Arabia that rely on the narrow but critical Strait of Hormuz for transit.

The Strait has been effectively blocked following a week-old escalation in the region, after US and Israeli strikes on Iran prompted Tehran to retaliate against US bases in neighbouring countries.

While India has surplus oil refining capacity, it is short in



India consumed 31.3 million tonnes of LPG in 2024-25, of which only 12.8 million tonnes were produced domestically, with remainder imported

LPG production. And now all public and private sector refineries have been asked to "maximise and ensure that propane and butane streams produced... are utilised for production of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG)," according to an oil ministry order of March 5.

Highlights

- » The LPG so produced is to be sold only to domestic households for cooking purposes
- » LPG under the recently signed LPG import contract with the US have also started coming in
- » Under the deal, PSU oil companies will import about 2.2 million tonnes of LPG from the US Gulf Coast in 2026 - roughly 10% of country's annual LPG imports

LPG is a mixture of propane and butane.

The order, issued under the powers derived from the Essential Commodities Act of 1955 (popularly called ESMA), asked the refiners to make such LPG produced available to three public sector oil mar-

keting companies - Indian Oil Corporation, Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd (HPCL) only.

The refiners have also been barred from using the two chemicals for producing petrochemicals. "All oil refining companies shall not divert, utilise, process, crack, convert or otherwise employ propane or butane stream for the manufacture of petrochemical products or other such downstream derivatives," the order said.

The LPG so produced is to be sold only to domestic households for use in cooking purposes, it said, adding any contravention of the order shall attract penal action.

India has 33.08 crore active LPG consumers, and the government is looking to maintain an uninterrupted supply.

Earlier, the government invoked ESMA provisions in the oil sector during the post-Ukraine war period, asking refiners to ensure domestic fuel availability and not to export,

which had become lucrative due to high margins.

A top Oil Ministry official said the oil and gas supplies through the Strait of Hormuz have been impacted and the country was sourcing fuel from outside of the conflict zone.

LPG under the recently signed LPG import contract with the United States have also started coming in. Under the deal, public sector oil companies will import about 2.2 million tonnes of LPG from the US Gulf Coast in 2026 - roughly 10 per cent of the country's annual LPG imports - in a move to diversify energy sources and bolster energy security.

While the country has adequate stock of crude oil (raw material for making petrol and diesel), as much as 30 per cent of the gas supplies have been hit.

To deal with the situation, allocation is being re-prioritised - enforcing supply cuts for some and augmenting those for critical sectors, he said.

Adani Total Gas keeps CNG and domestic PNG prices unchanged

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Adani Total Gas Ltd (ATGL) has not raised prices of CNG and piped cooking gas supplied to households, even as it has imposed supply curbs on some large industrial consumers amid the escalating West Asia crisis affecting gas supplies, officials said on Friday.

A company official said about 70 per cent of ATGL's gas volumes are sourced domestically and supplied to CNG users and domestic kitchens (called piped natural gas (PNG)-domestic) customers. Prices for these segments of vehicle owners and residential households remain unchanged.

ATGL, the city gas joint venture of the Adani Group and French energy major TotalEnergies, sources the remaining around 30 per cent of gas volumes through imported LNG. This is supplied to commercial and industrial users.

As the escalating war halted the movement of ships through the Strait of Hormuz - the narrow sealane through which India gets a bulk of its crude oil and LNG supplies - the imported fuel segment has seen disruption.

Due to supply chain disruption



tions linked to the West Asia crisis, commercial and industrial customers have been asked to curtail consumption to 40 per cent of their contracted volumes, the official said.

Customers will continue to be billed at their contracted rates for consumption up to the 40 per cent limit, allowing them flexibility to shift to alternative fuel sources if needed.

The contracted price on average is around Rs 40 per standard cubic meter. The average term contract price across industry is Rs 40 per scm.

Spot market rates will apply only to consumption beyond this threshold, the official added.

The gas supply over 40 per cent of DCQ (daily contracted quantity) is a customer initiative by ATGL to support those

customers who need fuel for their business commitments and are not able to source alternative fuels.

The spot price reflects the alternative gas sourcing that the company had to do to fill the imported LNG gap. Spot rates are more than double the peacetime LNG prices - \$24-25 per million British thermal unit as compared to \$10 per mmbtu previously.

Commercial and industrial users who use gas beyond the 40 per cent limit will be charged Rs 119 per scm (Standard Cubic Meter) on the incremental volumes. The company added that it is making every possible effort to ensure uninterrupted gas supplies while managing supply challenges and protecting consumer interests across segments.

PTI



GOVERNMENT OF WEST BENGAL

NEW TOWN KOLKATA DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

NOTICE INVITING ONLINE ITEM RATE e-QUOTATION NO.: WBNKDA/25/ EE-P&GV /NKDA OF 2025-26 (2nd Call)

e-Tender has been invited for the following Tender ID

1. : 2026_NKDA_1019052_1

2. : 2026_NKDA_1019052_2

3. : 2026_NKDA_1019052_3

4. : 2026_NKDA_1019052_4

For maintaining Arboriculture, Last date & time of submission of technical and financial bid (On-line): 21/03/2026 upto 1.00 P.M. Details available on Website: <https://www.tenders.gov.in> & www.nkdamar.org and the office notice board of NKDA

Executive Engineer (P&GV)

New Town Kolkata Development Authority

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Arman Ali S/o Md. Ishak R/o H. No. F-473, F-Block, Khadda Colony, Jaitpur Extention Part II, New Delhi has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 27398/2022 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Arman Ali cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Arman Ali has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Arman Ali of case FIR No. 27398/2022 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 10.04.2026.

By Order

Ms. Akansha Gautam

Judicial Magistrate First Class-02

South East, Room No. 513

Saket Courts, Delhi

DPI/2910/SE/2026 (Court Matter)

OFFICE OF THE MUNICIPAL CORPORATION BHOPAL

Lake Conservation Cell

No.205/ LCC/BMC/2026 Bhopal Dated: 06.03.2026

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER

Online Percentage rate Tender are inviting from the appropriate class of contractors registered in office of the Govt. of Madhya Pradesh (Centralized Registration Cell) for the following works so as to be submitted bid online. The tender documents can be obtained online on the website <http://mptenders.gov.in> as per the Key Dates. The Notice published on the above website can also be seen on website www.bhopalmunicipal.com

S. No.	Details of Work	Qty.	Estimated Cost	Earnest Money (EMD)	Cost of Tender Document	Completion Period
1	CONSTRUCTION OF SATSANG HALL AT IDGHA HILLS, COMMUNITY HALL NEAR MACHNA COLONY, COMMUNITY HALL AT BHEL SANGAM COLONY, DEVELOPMENT WORK AT BHOJURI VISHRAM GHAT, WORKS AT SECOND FLOOR DISTRICT BAR COUNCIL	As per schedule	Rs. 2,34,47,709/-	Rs. 1,17,239/-	Rs. 15000/-	06 Months

Estimated cost does not include GST. GST as applicable on the date of payment will be paid separately.General Terms and Conditions:

1. Tender documents can be purchased only online from <http://mptenders.gov.in> by making online payment.

2. The bid data should be filled and the bid seals (hashes) of all the envelops and the documents which are to be uploaded by the bidders should be submitted online up to as per time schedule (Key dates).

3. The bidders shall have to submit their bids online.

4. Earnest money deposit on line in favor of the Commissioner Municipal Corporation Bhopal via payment gateway of E-Tendering portal.

5. The rates quoted by Bidder shall be excluding GST.

6. Conditional tender shall liable to be rejected.

7. The bidder shall have to submit:

a. Valid GST registration certificate.

b.Valid PWD Registration Certificate.

c. Valid EPF Registration Certificate.

d. Organizational details, as per enclosed Annexure – H

Sd/- Executive Engineer

Municipal Corporation, Bhopal

T.N.3275/025/026

Noida New Okhla Industrial Development Authority

Main Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida, G.B. Nagar, (U.P.) Website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited from eligible contractors/firm for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened / downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/ amendments & corrigendum etc.

A) Fresh-Tender Work:

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
1	31/SM (WC -4)/ ET/2025-26	D/o and Maint. of Village (R/o damaged Approach road of Chhajarsi Shamshan Ghat), Noida.	22.57
2	03/GM/SM(WC-1)/2025-26	Boundary wall and Barbed wire (P/F Concertina wire behind H.No.-111-158 and SDF/Indian Oil Servant Quarter 251 to 263 back side boundary wall in Sector-15A), Noida	13.59
3	05/GM/SM(WC-1)/2025-26	M/o Building (Construction of Toilet near Gate No.-5 in Sector-55), Noida	23.27
4	54/DGM/SM(WC-5)/2025-26	M/o Village (Repair and Renovation of Primary School under Operation Kayakalp in Village Chaura), Noida	28.82

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 09.03.2026 to 23.03.2026 up to 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 24.03.2026 at 11.00 AM.

B) Re-Tender Work:

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
5	28/DGM/SM(WC-3)/2025-26	M/o Building (C/o One Room with Toilet for Library in Community Centre Hoshiyarpur), Noida.	20.95
6	08/DGM/SM(WC-3)/2025-26	M/o Building (Demolishing & Re-Construction of Urinal on NRI road Sector-96 side), Noida	6.96
7	12/SM (WC -4)/ ET/2025-26	M/o Road (C/o Table Top speed Breaker on Internal roads in Sector-63A), Noida	12.53

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 09.03.2026 to 16.03.2026 up to 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 17.03.2026 at 11.00 AM.

General Manager (Civil)

Noida

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

कार्यालय जिला अभियंता, जिला परिषद, पलामू

Email:- zilaparishad.palamu@gmail.com

अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई- संख्या- DOPR/DE/ZP/Palamu 23/2025-26

विज्ञापन दाता का नाम	—	जिला अभियंता, जिला परिषद, पलामू।
Website पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि	—	दिनांक 10.03.2026 (पूर्वाह्न 10:00 बजे)
ई-निविदा प्राप्त करने की तिथि	—	दिनांक 10.03.2026 (पूर्वाह्न 10:00 बजे) से दिनांक 25.03.2026 (अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक)
निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय	—	दिनांक 27.03.2026 (पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे)
निविदा खोलने का स्थान	—	कार्यालय जिला परिषद, पलामू।
कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :-		

क्र०	प्रखण्ड	पंचायत/ग्राम	योजना का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रघन की राशि	निविदा शुल्क	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	एनओआईटीओ रफरेंस सं०
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	मोलावर-पीताम्बरपुर	गोराडीह/गोराडीह	प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र गोराडीह का निर्माण।	14300000	286000	10000	12 माह	NIT-23/2025-26/ Gr-01
2	तरहसी	तरहसी/तरहसी	प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र तरहसी का निर्माण।	14300000	286000	10000	12 माह	NIT-23/2025-26/ Gr-02
3	पाटन	कसावाखार/नावाजयपुर	प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र नावाजयपुर का निर्माण।	14300000	286000	10000	12 माह	NIT-23/2025-26/ Gr-03
4	हरिहरगंज	दकचा/दकचा	प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र दकचा का निर्माण।	14300000	286000	10000	12 माह	NIT-23/2025-26/ Gr-04
5	हरिहरगंज (पीपर)	मधुबाना/मधुबाना	प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र मधुबाना का निर्माण।	14300000	286000	10000	12 माह	NIT-23/2025-26/ Gr-05
6	हुसैनाबाद	दरुआवेनी/बुलंदवीधा	प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र बुलंदवीधा का निर्माण।	14300000	286000	10000	12 माह	NIT-23/2025-26/ Gr-06
7	पोंकी	कल्ला/बोरादीरी	प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र बोरादीरी का निर्माण।	14300000	286000	10000	12 माह	NIT-23/2025-26/ Gr-07
8	हुसैनाबाद	महुअरी/डिहरी	प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र डिहरी विश्रामपुर महुअरी का निर्माण।	14300000	286000	10000	12 माह	NIT-23/2025-26/ Gr-08

नोट- 1. केवल ई-निविदा ही स्वीकार होंगे।

2. निविदा डबल बीड पद्धति से होगी।

3. जिला परिषद, पलामू में समुचित श्रेणी में निर्धारित संवेदक ही निविदा में भाग ले सकेंगे।

4. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।

5. निविदा शुल्क (Non Refundable) एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल Demand Draft (किसी भी मान्यता प्राप्त बैंक द्वारा निर्गत) जिला अभियंता, जिला परिषद, पलामू (District Engineer, Zila Parishad, Palamu) के पदनाम से डाल्टनगंज में भुगतान होगा, के रूप में स्वीकार्य होगी।

निविदा की तकनीकी एवं सामान्य शर्तें www.palamu.nic.in एवं कार्यालय जिला परिषद, पलामू के सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है। विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए Website-www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

हो/—

जिला अभियंता, जिला परिषद, पलामू

PR 374278 District(25-26).D

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the newspapers, social media platforms & website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: BIENNIAL ELECTION TO THE COUNCIL OF STATES TO FILL UP FIVE SEATS FROM WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - West Bengal

Name of the candidate – Shri Babul Supriya Baral

Sl.no.		
1.	Criminal antecedents	
i)	a. Nature of the offences	1. 186/143/283 of the Indian Penal Code and 8(B)(II) NH Act 1956 2. 188 of the Indian Penal Code and 32 of the Police Act 3. 504 of the Indian Penal Code 4. 166/323/353/355 of the Indian Penal Code 5. 509 of the Indian Penal Code 6. 143/147/149/153A/186/ 188/ 353 of the Indian Penal Code 7. 500/504/506/509 of the Indian Penal Code 8. 171C/268/427 of the Indian Penal Code 9. 143/342/186/353/506 of the Indian Penal Code 10. 143/186/283/506 of the Indian Penal Code 11. 353/186/188/506/120B of the Indian Penal Code 12. 143/147/149/153A/186/188/353 of the Indian Penal Code 13. Information Not Available 14. 341/323/34/354/506/509 of the Indian Penal Code 15. 171C/500 of the Indian Penal Code 16. 419/506 of the Indian Penal Code 17. 153A/505/120B of the Indian Penal Code and RW 66/43 Information Technology Act 18. 506 of the Indian Penal Code
	b. Case no.	1. FIR Case No. 129/14 Dt. 12/04/14 2. Case No. 84/16 Dt. 09/04/16 3. FIR Case No. 129 Dt. 29/04/16 4. Case No. 438/16 Dt. 21/10/16 5. FIR Case No. 62 Dt 04/01/17 6. FIR Case No. 97/18 Dt 29/03/18 7. Case No. 95/19 Dt. 19.3.2019 8. FIR NGR No. 948/19 Dt. 18/04/19 9. Case No. 171/19 Dt. 21/04/19 10. Case No. 113 of 2019 Dt. 14/04/19 11. FIR Case No. 40/19 Dt. 29/04/19 12. FIR Case No. 32/19 Dt. 2019 13. FIR NGR No. 34/19 Dt. 2019 14. FIR Case No. 347 Dt 22/09/19 15. FIR NGR No. 995/19 Dt. 2019 16. Case No. 150 of Dt. 01.06.2019 17. FIR Case No. 78 Dt. 09/05/20 18. FIR Case No. 31 Dt. 31/03/21
	c. Name of the Court	1. In the Court of the LD MPS & MLAS Court, Barasat, North 24 PGS. LD. Judge Special Court 2. In the Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol 3. In the Court of the LD. A.C.J.M Alipore Bankshall Court 4. In the Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol 5. In the Court of the LD. MPS & MLAS Court, Barasat, North 24 PGS. LD. Judge Special Court 6. In the Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol 7. In the Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol 8. In the Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol 9. In the Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol 10. In the Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol 11. In the Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol 12. In the Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol 13. In the Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol 14. In the Court of the LD. ACJM, Alipore 15. In the Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol 16. In the Court of the LD. CJM, Paschim Bardhaman at Asansol 17. In the Court of the LD. ACJM Alipore 18. In the Court of the LD. ACJM Alipore
	d. Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	No
	e. Date of conviction, if any	N/A
	f. Details of punishment undergone, if any	N/A
	g. Any other information required to be given	N/A
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)	The candidate is a widely respected public figure with a distinguished career spanning public service and cultural life. A renowned playback singer with national recognition, he has contributed significantly to India's music and cultural landscape. In public life, he has served as a Member of Parliament and held responsibilities as a Minister in the Government of West Bengal. His experience in governance, legislative affairs, and public engagement, combined with his cultural outreach and connection with diverse communities, equips him to contribute meaningfully to parliamentary deliberations in the Rajya Sabha.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)	Same As Above.

(2) Name of the Constituency – WEST BENGAL

Name of the candidate: SHRI BABUL SUPRIYA BARAL

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party

Name and Designation

Derek O'Brien

National Working Committee Member

All India Trinamool Congress

WEST ASIA CRISIS

Govt will use every policy tool to help exporters, says Goyal

The Commerce and Industry Minister said that the government has set up an inter-ministerial group to look into the issues on a daily basis

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government will use all policy tools and support measures to help domestic exporters deal with the ongoing West Asia crisis, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Friday.

He said that the government has set up an inter-ministerial group to look into the issues on a daily basis.

"And the government will use every policy tool and the export promotion mission to support our exporters...We will be formalising some ways to give comfort to our exporters," Goyal told reporters here on the sidelines of IIFT's vice chancellors' conclave.

He was responding to the demands of exporters seeking government intervention to help them tide over the problems following the disruptions in the movements of goods on account of the ongoing war between the US and Israel with Iran.

Exporters are facing issues with regard to the movement of consignments to West Asia as certain shipping lines are



Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal

In 2025, India imported \$98.7 bn worth of goods from West Asia. While, exports to the West Asiastood at \$58.8 bn in FY25

demanding high war-risk surcharges of up to \$4,000 per 40 ft container, and some ships are stranded in international waters.

These developments have significantly pushed freight rates and insurance premiums.

West Asia is a key trading partner of India. In 2025, India imported \$98.7 billion worth of

Highlights

» Exporters are facing shortage of containers, suspension, cancellation of vessel calls to the Middle East and sharply higher logistics costs

» 'India would continue to meet all commitments that the country's industries have made to foreign buyers

» Global freight rates have risen by 15-20%. War-risk surcharges, insurance premiums for shipments to Gulf have jumped significantly

goods from West Asia, making the region a crucial supplier for energy, fertilisers and industrial raw materials. Exports to the West Asian economies stood at \$58.8 billion in 2024-25.

The commerce ministry, Goyal said, is in dialogue with the ministry of shipping and with shipping companies on the issues of exporters. "And I

do hope we will find a resolution to this issue also," he said.

When asked about the issue of rising freight costs, he said the ministry is working with them to see how the burden on exporters can be mitigated.

"Every day the inter-ministerial group talks to the exporters...They take feedback, and we will not be found wanting in supporting our exporters in any way," he said.

He added that India would continue to meet all the commitments that the country's industries have made to foreign buyers in goods and services.

"But I can assure you, this government stands with our industry and will continue to ensure that all our international commitments are met. Because that is what defines India," he said, adding that even during Covid, India met all its international commitments, "which earned us the acronym of a trusted partner".

Exporters are seeking higher RoDTEP (Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) rates, urging the Export Credit Guarantee Corporation of India (ECGC) not

to raise insurance premiums, ad hoc working-capital limits and credit extensions similar to measures provided during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Exporters are facing shortage of containers, suspension or cancellation of vessel calls to the Middle East, and sharply higher logistics costs.

They have also sought urgent government support to mitigate the impact of shipping disruptions triggered by the Iran crisis and instability across key maritime routes.

International freight rates have risen by an estimated 15-20 per cent, while war-risk surcharges and insurance premiums for Gulf-bound shipments have increased significantly. Bunker fuel costs have also climbed, with marine fuel oil prices rising to around \$580 per tonne from about \$520, IREF has said.

They are urging the government to waive port-related charges, including storage and demurrage, in cases where cargo is rolled due to vessel cancellations or steep freight increases beyond exporters' control.

Markets tank over 1%, Sensex falls nearly 1100 pts as oil prices soar

Rupee depreciates by 18 paise to 91.82 against US dollar

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Stock market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty tumbled over 1 per cent on Friday after a day's breather as the conflict in the Middle East entered the seventh day, driving crude oil prices higher.

The 30-share BSE Sensex tumbled 1,097 points, or 1.37 per cent, to settle at 78,918.90. During the day, it sank 1,203.72 points, or 1.50 per cent, to 78,812.18.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dropped 315.45 points, or 1.27 per cent, to end at 24,450.45.

Weakness in the US equities, subdued trend in European markets and relentless foreign fund outflows also dampened investor sentiment, analysts said.

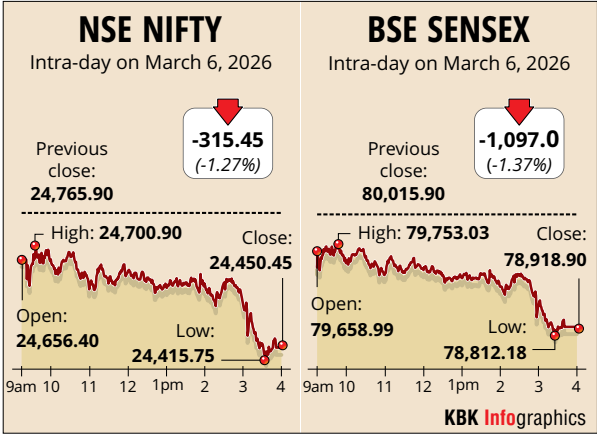
From the Sensex pack, Eternal, ICICI Bank, Axis Bank, UltraTech Cement, HDFC Bank, State Bank of India, Bajaj Finserv, and Larsen & Toubro were among the major laggards.

Bharat Electronics, Reliance Industries, Sun Pharma, NTPC, Infosys, and HCL Tech were the gainers.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 2.53 per cent to \$87.57 per barrel.

The BSE midcap select index dropped 1.10 per cent and smallcap select index dipped 0.43 per cent.

BSE top 10 banks tanked 2.37 per cent, private banks index by 2.25 per cent, bankex by 2.14 per cent, financial ser-



A total of 2,304 stocks declined, 1,895 advanced and 175 remained unchanged on the BSE

vices by 2.12 per cent, BSE PSU bank by 1.99 per cent and services by 1.35 per cent.

Capital Goods, industrials and power were the gainers. A total of 2,304 stocks declined while 1,895 advanced and 175 remained unchanged on the BSE.

On the weekly front, the BSE benchmark tanked 2,368.29 points or 2.91 per cent, and the Nifty declined 728.2 points or 2.89 per cent.

The rupee depreciated 18 paise against the US dollar on Friday to close at 91.82 against

the American currency, as surging crude oil prices and a shift toward risk-aversion weighed on the currency.

In Asian markets, South Korea's Kospi, Japan's Nikkei 225, Shanghai's SSE Composite index and Hong Kong's Hang Seng index ended higher.

Markets in Europe were trading in negative territory. The US market ended lower on Thursday.

FII's offloaded equities worth Rs 3,752.52 crore on Thursday, while Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs) bought stocks worth Rs 5,153.37 crore, according to exchange data.

On Thursday, the Sensex rebounded 899.71 points, or 1.14 per cent, to settle at 80,015.90, snapping its four-day decline. The Nifty climbed 285.40 points, or 1.17 per cent, to end at 24,765.90, ending its three-day falling streak.

India's forex stocks jump \$4.885 bn to \$728.494 bn

MUMBAI: India's forex reserves jumped \$4.885 billion to an all-time high of \$728.494 billion during the week ended February 27, the Reserve Bank said on Friday.

In the previous reporting week, the overall reserves had dropped \$2.119 billion to \$723.608 billion. The previous all time high for the kitty was \$725.727 billion during the week ended February 13 this year.

For the week ended February 27, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, increased \$561 million to \$573.125 billion, the data released by the central bank showed.

Expressed in dollar terms, the foreign currency assets include the effects of appreciation or depreciation of non-US units, such as the euro, pound, and yen, held in the foreign exchange reserves.

Value of the gold reserves increased \$4.141 billion to \$131.630 billion during the week, the RBI said.

The Special Drawing Rights (SDRs) were up \$26 million to \$18.87 billion, the apex bank said.

India's reserve position with the International Monetary Fund (IMF) was also up \$158 million to \$4.87 billion in the reporting week, according to the apex bank's data.

RBI to conduct ₹1 lakh crore OMO purchase of G-Sec on March 9 & 13

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Friday said it will conduct Rs 1-lakh crore open market operation (OMO) purchase of government securities in two tranches on March 9 and March 13.

Each tranche of the auction will consist of Rs 50,000 crore, it said.

The OMO purchase auction was announced following a review of the current liquidity and financial conditions, RBI said in a release.

In the first auction, the central bank is scheduled to buy G-secs such as 6.01 per cent GS 2030, 6.10 per cent GS 2031, 7.18 per cent GS 2033, 6.19 per cent GS 2034, 6.33 per cent GS 2035, 6.92 per cent GS 2039, and 7.30 per cent GS 2053, the release added.

The first auction will take place on March 9, between 9:30



am and 10:30 am on March 9, 2026.

"The result of the auction will be announced on the same day, and successful participants should ensure the availability of securities in their SGL account by 12 noon on March 10, 2026," RBI said.

The OMO purchase auction was announced ahead of expected heavy outflows from the banking system due to advance tax and Goods and

The OMO purchase auction was announced following a review of the current liquidity and financial conditions, RBI said in a release

Services Tax (GST) payments scheduled later this month.

This comes even as liquidity conditions in the banking system currently remain in a significant surplus of Rs 3.02 lakh crore.

As per Reserve Bank data, the central bank has infused Rs 2.50 lakh crore through open market operation purchases of government securities so far since the start of this calendar year.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



NBCC, observed the 55th Safety Week 2026 with a pledge-taking ceremony emphasizing, On the occasion, Dr. K P Mahadevaswamy, CMD, NBCC, administered the Safety Pledge to employees, encouraging them to uphold the highest standards of safety at all work sites and offices. The pledge ceremony was attended by Anjeev Kumar Jain, Director (Finance), Ritu Pande, Chief Vigilance Officer, and other senior officers of the company.



Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd (HPCL) has signed an agreement with the Institute of Fire, Safety & Disaster Management Studies (IFSDFS) to strengthen emergency response capabilities through specialised Live Fire Training for its officers. The pact was signed by Dharmendra Kumar Sharma, Executive Director – Health, Safety & Environment (HSE), HPCL, and Dharmendra Wakharikar, Chief Coordinator, IFSDFS, in the presence of Vikram Mahurkar, President, IFSDFS and Managing Director, Checkmate Group.

Generali Central Insurance launches its branch in Siliguri, West Bengal

SILIGURI: Generali Central Insurance, a joint venture between global insurance major Generali and Central Bank of India announced the launch of its branch in Siliguri, West Bengal.

This is the second branch opening in the eastern region after Bhubaneswar.

This milestone marks a significant step forward underscoring the brand's commitment to providing comprehensive solutions to its customers.

The launch event was graced by Anup Rau, the Managing Director and CEO of Generali Central Insurance.

Speaking on the occasion,

The new branch in Siliguri is expected to help in expanding Generali Central Insurance's footprint in North Bengal

Anup Rau, MD and CEO of Generali Central Insurance, said: "This branch launch is a testament to our growth potential and the increasing business opportunities in this region. By bringing comprehensive insurance solutions under one roof,

we are strengthening our ability to serve customers more effectively and build deeper partnerships with our Bancassurance partners, advisors, motor dealer partners and other intermediaries. Through our bancassurance collaborations, we are also able to significantly extend our reach, leveraging nearly 2,900 partner bank branches across the region to make our solutions more accessible to customers."

The new branch in Siliguri is expected to help in expanding Generali Central Insurance's footprint in North Bengal or semi urban and rural markets of the East.

MPOST

Gold declines ₹1,100 to ₹1.64 lakh per 10 grams, silver slips to ₹2.71 lakh/kg

NEW DELHI: Gold prices declined Rs 1,100 to Rs 1.64 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Friday as traders booked profits at elevated levels for the second straight session, while silver also slipped to Rs 2.71 lakh per kilogram.

According to the All India Sarafa Association, the yellow metal of 99.9 per cent purity depreciated Rs 1,100, or nearly 1 per cent, to Rs 1,64,100 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes).

Silver also fell Rs 600 to Rs 2,71,700 per kg (inclusive of all taxes) in the bullion market.

Analysts said traders locked

in gains after the recent sharply in precious metal prices, even as global trends remained mixed.

However, in the international markets, bullion prices were trading higher on renewed safe-haven demand, with spot gold gaining \$14.70, or 0.29 per cent, to \$5,095.81 per ounce, while silver increasing 1.4 per cent to \$83.40 per ounce.

Traders said escalating tensions in the Middle East continued to support precious metals, though profit-booking limited gains in the domestic markets.

India must move from reactive probe to predictive fraud prevention

‘Close coordination among corporates & law enforcement agencies important to effectively tackle forensic fraud’

NEW DELHI: Strengthening India's fraud prevention framework requires a comprehensive and multi-layered strategy combining legal reforms, technology adoption, early warning systems and greater public awareness, Garima Bhatnagar, Special CP, Economic Offences Wing, Delhi Police, said on Friday at a FICCI conference on "Forensics of Fraud Investigation."

She stressed the need to move from a reactive investigation model to predictive prevention by using integrative intelligence, advanced technologies, robust red-flag mechanisms, stronger institutional coordination and faster asset

recovery systems. Bhatnagar said governments across the country are reinforcing enforcement capabilities by strengthening Economic Offences Wings in states, expanding cybercrime units and tightening regulatory frameworks. These measures include stricter anti-money laundering (AML) norms, digital KYC requirements, improved transaction monitoring and deeper international cooperation to combat financial crimes more effectively.

Dr Jaspal Singh, former Director General of Police, Goa, and Chair Professor at the Department of Behavioral Forensics, National Forensic Science University under the

CLOSER LOOK

» Garima Bhatnagar, Special CP, Economic Offences Wing, Delhi Police said govts across the country are strengthening Economic Offences Wings in states, expanding cybercrime units

» 'Cybercriminal networks are increasingly adopting artificial intelligence, significantly raising the scale and sophistication of fraud'

» 'AI-generated phishing messages and fraudulent emails are estimated to be up to four times more effective while requiring much less effort to produce'

Ministry of Home Affairs, highlighted the need to expand and train skilled manpower across forensic science disciplines. He proposed setting up a Forensic

Council of India, on the lines of the Arbitration Council of India, to institutionalize and strengthen the role of forensic science in the justice system.

Manoj Kumar Meena, Director (NCTAU/Data Analytics) at the Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre (I4C), Ministry of Home Affairs, warned about the growing threat posed by cybercrime. He noted that cybercriminal networks are increasingly adopting artificial intelligence, significantly raising the scale and sophistication of fraud.

According to Meena, AI-generated phishing messages and fraudulent emails are estimated to be up to four times more effective while requiring much less effort to produce, making such attacks easier to scale and execute.

Sanjay Kaushik, member

of the FICCI Corporate Security and Disaster Risk Reduction Committee and managing director of Netrika Consulting India Pvt Ltd, stressed the importance of close coordination among corporates, law enforcement agencies, regulators, forensic professionals and technology experts to effectively tackle forensic fraud.

The conference brought together regulators, law enforcement officials, industry leaders, forensic experts and technology specialists to discuss emerging fraud patterns, digital evidence management and collaborative approaches to strengthen fraud detection and investigation in India.

AGENCIES

GOVERNMENT OF WEST BENGAL

CORRIGENDUM NOTICE

Notice Inviting e-Tender No. 25/EE-SWM/NKDA/2025-26

Name of Work: 1. Maintenance of Prefabricated Single Tank Based Modular Capacity 05 TPD Bio-Gas Plant in Connection with Solid Waste Management at Newtown, Kolkata under NKDA for 02 Years.

Last date of Online submission of Technical Bid and Financial Bid: 13.03.2026 upto 01:00 pm. (For SI. No. - 01) & For other details please visit our website at www.nkdamar.org & <https://sbtenders.gov.in> and the office notice board Newtown, Kolkata -700156.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
(Solid Waste Management)
New Town Kolkata Development Authority

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSONS

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons (1) **Arun @ Ballu S/o Jag Mohan Lal, R/o H.No.-68/2, Gali No.-1, Ajeet Vihar, Burari, Delhi.** (2) **Sandeep Kumar S/o Sant Vijay, R/o H.No. 810, Block-B, Indraprastha Colony, Gali No.-23, Amrit Bihar, North Delhi-84,** have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 384/2021, U/S 308/326/201/120B/34 IPC & 25/27/54 Arms Act, PS Swaroop Nagar, Outer-North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused persons cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused persons have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant);
Proclamation is hereby made that (1) **Arun @ Ballu (2) Sandeep Kumar** the said accused of **FIR No. 384/2021, U/S 308/326/201/120B/34 IPC & 25/27/54 Arms Act, PS Swaroop Nagar, Outer-North Distt., Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.04.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Vandana
Additional Sessions Judge-02 (North)
Room No.-202, 2nd Floor,
District Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/2897/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Balram S/o Mahender Sharma R/o Adhyapak Nagar, Nangloi, Delhi, also at: (1) D-76, Adhyapak Nagar, Nangloi, Delhi, also at: (2) Village Dhak Pura, Distt. Badayun, U.P.** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence Case **FIR No. 39/19 u/s 379/411/279/337/34 IPC** at P.S. Nihal Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Balram** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Balram** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C. has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Balram** accused of **FIR No. 39/19 u/s 379/411/279/337/34 IPC** at P.S. Nihal Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **27.04.2026.**

By Order: Ms. Komal Garg,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
(West Distt.) Court No. 292,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi.

DP/2888/OD/2026

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB

GREATER LUDHIANA AREA DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

GLADA Office, Rajguru Nagar, Ferozepur Road, Ludhiana

Tender reference No.GLADA-DE (H)-Ldh-2026/195 dated 06-03-2026

Divisional Engineer (H), GLADA, Ludhiana re-invites online bids for "Maintenance of horticulture works in Urban Estate Sector 32-A, 33, EWS Pocket Sector-32, 39-A, commercial pocket Sector 39, 100 sayd Sector-38, Sector 40, Park in Dhandari Kalan, PH-2, 4 & GLADA Nursery , Samrala road, Ludhiana and Urban Estate Phase-III & 200'-0" Bypass, Missing Link-1 & 2, GLADA Heights, Dugri road Ludhiana and cutting of wild growth in various Urban Estates of GLADA (From 01-04-2026 to 31-03-2027)"

Closing date & time: 17-03-2026 at 1.00 PM.

For details log on to: <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

Note: Any corrigendum(s) to the tender notice shall be published on the above website only.

RO No PR-Advt. No :- 1323/12/2025-26/9105

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER

PUBLIC WORK DEPARTMENT, BILASPUR CIRCLE

BILASPUR, CHHATTISGARH

AMENDMENT NOTICE

Amendment are made in N.I.T. No. 509 /G/2025-26/dated 17.02.2026:-

NIT No.	Existing Description	To be extended
509	Last date of tender download - 03.03.2026	Last date of tender download - 09.03.2026

Other conditions will remain same.

G 25260705/5

Superintending Engineer
PWD, Bilaspur Circle
Bilaspur (CG)

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited

Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN U40109TG1997PLC028483

(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)

(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-Electrical, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of:

1. Tender Enquiry No. 129/GATP/EMD/60001821 dated 06/03/2026
"Procurement of 2.2 Ton Air Conditioners (Split Type: SRK25CS5-S6/A, (TON: 2.2 Make: Mitsubishi Heavy Duty) at GATP" at 21270 A/W/ Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 06/03/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

GATP-23/26

PR-Advt. No :- 1079/12/2025-26/9146

Govt. of Jharkhand

ROAD CONSTRUCTION DEPARTMENT

Road Division, Seraikella-Kharsawan

e-Procurement Notice

Tender Reference No. RCD/SERAIKELLA/23 Date :- 05.03.2026

1.	Name of the work	IRQP work of Adardih (NH-32) to Milan Chowk (MDR-25) Road from Km 0.00 to Km 32.10 (Total Length: 32.10 Km) for the year 2025-26
2.	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Rs. 18,08,15,622.89 (Rupees Eighteen Crore Eight Lakh Fifteen Thousand Six Hundred Twenty Two and Paise Eighty Nine only)
3.	Time of Completion	06 (Six) months
4.	Last Date /Time for receipt of bids	01.04.2026 (12.00 Noon)
5.	Date of Publication of Tender on website	12.03.2026 (10.30AM)
6.	Name & Address of office Inviting tender	O/o Executive Engineer, Road Construction Department, Road Division, Seraikella-Kharsawan 9199867872
7.	Contact no. of Procurement Officer	9199867872
8.	Helpline number of e-Procurement cell	0651-2401010

Further details can be seen on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>
Executive Engineer
RCD, Road Division
Seraikella-kharsawan

PR 374191 Road (25-26)_D

It's coming home, again?

After a rollercoaster ride into the final, Motera set for a blue wave

S KANNAN

AHMEDABAD: It has been one hell of a journey for the India in the ICC Men's T20 World Cup. Riding the highs of back-to-back wins over West Indies and England, Suryakumar Yadav and his motivated squad have now arrived in Ahmedabad for the title clash against the New Zealand national cricket team. The final will be played at the colossal Narendra Modi Stadium on Sunday.

The emotions from Wankhede Stadium on Thursday night, when India sealed victory against England in a high-scoring thriller, will not fade easily. What happened inside the stadium was only one part of the story. Outside, along the Marine Drive, a sea of blue captured the mood of the nation.

A win by just seven runs in a match that produced 499 runs is a rarity in T20 Internationals. The pitch at Mumbai's iconic venue is known to favour batters. For bowlers, however, the challenge is immense. They must innovate constantly and keep their composure under pressure. Ahmedabad may be famous for its traders and stock market enthusiasts, but it is also the city that produced one



After the England scalp, India now shifts focus to the final against New Zealand

PTI

of India's greatest fast bowlers — Jasprit Bumrah. Having honed his craft here, Bumrah has become India's spearhead with the white ball.

Even on Thursday night, during the tense death overs, Bumrah was nailing his trademark yorkers. It is difficult to imagine Indian cricket without him, regardless of the format. Despite managing recurring fitness concerns and a heavy workload, Bumrah thrives at the Narendra Modi Stadium and will relish the chance to showcase his skills against the Black Caps.

There has been talk that the venue is somehow "unlucky" for India. Blaming the Nar-

endra Modi Stadium for the loss in the 2023 ICC ODI World Cup final on November 19, 2023 is misplaced. On

that day, Australia were simply outstanding.

Some may also point out that South Africa national cricket team defeated India at the same venue earlier in this tournament. But that is merely a statistic.

With a record capacity of more than 125,000, the Narendra Modi Stadium is an imposing arena and a dream stage for any cricketer. With its vast boundaries and scale, Ahmedabad has emerged as India's most significant cricket venue.

Those who argue that the final should have been played in Eden Gardens in Kolkata or at Wankhede Stadium in Mumbai can debate all they

AFC WOMEN'S ASIAN CUP

India look to bounce back against Japan



India's Manisha Kalyan in action against Vietnam

AIFF

PERTH: A gritty performance in their previous group game would have certainly boosted their confidence but India's task would be cut out when they face a formidable Japan in their second match of the AFC Women's Asian Cup here on Saturday.

India conceded an injury time goal, just three minutes before the final hooter to suffer 1-2 defeat to Vietnam and lose a valuable point in their opening Group C match on Wednesday.

Vietnam featured in the 2023 FIFA World Cup, and a gutsy fight against them and an equalising goal through debutant Sanfida Nongrum would

instil confidence among Amelia Valverde's wards.

But world No. 8 and two-time champions Japan will be a totally different side, vastly superior than the Indians. Valverde's task could be more of maintaining compactness and working on defensive resilience, while looking to hit on the counter.

Valverde, however, expects her side to maintain the intensity it showed in the 1-2 defeat to Vietnam. "The team is feeling very good. We had the advantage of taking two days to recover and to prepare for this big game against a good team like Japan," said Valverde ahead of Saturday's match. AGENCIES

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Nitin Kumar S/o Kashmiri Lal R/o 177-178, 2nd Floor, Block-A, Pocket-3, Sector-28, Phase-4, Rohini, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 50/2026 U/s 21/25/61 NDPS Act, P.S. Ashok Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Nitin Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Nitin Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Nitin Kumar** of case **FIR No. 50/2026 U/s 21/25/61 NDPS Act, P.S. Ashok Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.04.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Shivaji Anand
Additional Session Judge-02, North West
Special Judge (NDPS), Room No. 409
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/2894/NW/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **1. Krishan @ Krish S/o Subhash R/o H. No. F-3/395, Sultanpur, Delhi 2. Kallu @ Rahul S/o Ramesh Mishra R/o H. No. F-3/365, Sultanpur, Delhi** have Committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 269/2019 U/s 129/55 Gambling Act, P.S. Raj Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **1. Krishan @ Krish 2. Kallu @ Rahul** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **1. Krishan @ Krish 2. Kallu @ Rahul** have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **1. Krishan @ Krish 2. Kallu @ Rahul** of case **FIR No. 269/2019 U/s 129/55 Gambling Act, P.S. Raj Park, Delhi** are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.04.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Ebbani Aggarwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North West, Court No. 107, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/2273/OD/2026 (Court Matter)

SILENCES DOUBTERS WITH MASTERCLAS

Samson's redemption song, loud and clear at Wankhede

MEENAKSHI RAO

MUMBAI: Sometimes redemption in sport does not arrive with a roar but with the cleanest swing of the bat.

On a high-scoring night at Wankhede Stadium, Sanju Samson's fluent 89 became the innings that nudged India into the final of the ICC Men's T20 World Cup. It was not a century — something Samson joked about later — but it was the kind of knock that quietly rewrites narratives.

India eventually edged England by seven runs in a semi-final that produced almost 500 runs. Yet the momentum had shifted much earlier, when Samson seized control of the evening with an innings built on poise and controlled aggression.

For a cricketer whose career has often swung between promise and opportunity, the moment carried personal weight.

"It feels really great, really relieved," Samson said afterwards. "For a few years I've been trying to do something like this for my country."

Relief was perhaps the most revealing word of the night. The last nine months have been far from straightforward for the



Sanju Samson's 89 was instrumental in India's win

PTI

“For a few years I've been trying to do something like this for my country”
Sanju Samson

31-year-old. He slipped down the batting order, struggled to convert starts during the New Zealand series, and began this World Cup watching from the bench. In Indian cricket, phases like that can swallow players whole. Samson chose a quieter path through the noise. "I shut down my phone. I stayed away from social media. Less noise

helped me focus," he said. That retreat brought him back to the fundamentals that define his batting — clean timing, fearless intent and an instinctive sense of T20 rhythm. At Wankhede, those instincts clicked perfectly with the conditions. "After the first over we knew the wicket was very good," Samson said. "In T20 cricket nowadays the powerplay decides a lot. The top three have to explode."

Explode he did. Samson batted with a fluency that made the innings feel inevitable once it gathered pace. Even a dropped chance midway through did little to interrupt the flow. "I was fortunate," he said with a grin. "But it was a ball to hit, so I hit it."

Rodrigues lone bright spot as Oz gain edge

Tottenham lose again and face fight for EPL relegation

PERTH: Jemimah Rodrigues fought bravely with a fifty but other India batters failed to counter the swing generated by Australian pacers Annabel Sutherland and debutant Lucy Hamilton, getting bundled out for a lowly 198 on the opening day of the one-off day-night Test here on Friday.

Rodrigues (52, 84b) looked fluent but did not have much backing from the rest of her colleagues.

The Indian pacers maintained a fine line outside the off-stump to nick off three Aussie top-order batters as the home side was placed at 96 for three at close.

Australia trail by 102 runs. The Aussies elected to field, and the decision proved right by Sutherland (4/46) and Hamilton (3/31) who bowled at a fair clip and produced disconcerting movement.

Left-arm pacer Hamilton struck the first blow, removing Smriti Mandhana in the sixth over itself, with a peach that came into the left-hander.

Shafali Verma (35) looked good for more, but Sutherland managed to move the ball just the right amount to find her outside edge for stumper Beth Mooney to finish the formalities.



Australian teen Lucy Hamilton picked up 3 wickets on Day 1

CA

Debutant Pratika Rawal (18), skipper Harmanpreet Kaur (19) and Deepti Sharma (7) departed without making any significant contributions, as India slipped to 107 for five.

But a 43-run association between Rodrigues and Richa Ghosh (11, 41b) for the sixth wicket carried India to 150.

However, Rodrigues and Ghosh fell to Hamilton and Ash Gardner in the space of an over as India once again found themselves in trouble at 150 for seven.

A 38-run alliance between the two other Indian debutants -- Kashvee Gautam (34 not out) and Sayali Satghare (7, 35b) -- for the ninth wicket helped India move closer to 200. AGENCIES

NZ ready for twin threat, says Phillips



Glenn Phillips during a training session

PTI

MEENAKSHI RAO

AHMEDABAD: For Glenn Phillips, the road to beating India in the ICC Men's T20 World Cup final begins with negotiating two bowlers capable of shaping the contest — Jasprit Bumrah and Varun Chakravathy.

As New Zealand prepare to walk into the cauldron of the Narendra Modi Stadium, where more than 100,000 spectators are expected, Phillips offered a glimpse into the tactical thinking within the Kiwi camp. His focus was less on the magnitude of the occasion and more on the craft required to counter India's most potent weapons.

India's attack offers multiple threats, but Phillips repeatedly returned to two names — Chakravathy, the mystery spinner who can strangle the middle overs, and Bumrah, the master of death bowling.

"We've played him quite a few times in the past now, which is helpful," Phillips said of Chakravathy. "But he's an incredible bowler and we just try to face it one ball at a time."

Chakravathy's strength lies in ambiguity — subtle variations in speed, wrist position and trajectory that make him difficult to read even for experienced batters. Phillips suggested that against bowlers of that kind, clarity of thought matters more than reckless aggression. "Obviously he's allowed to have a good day. But we're also allowed to have a good day," he said.

The remark reflected New Zealand's measured approach. Phillips, who often arrives around the 10th over, has built a reputation for dismantling spin with raw power. Yet against Chakravathy, brute force alone is rarely enough. Patience, instead, becomes the currency — absorbing pressure and waiting for the rare loose ball. If Chakravathy is the puzzle through the middle overs, Bumrah represents the storm at the end.

The New Zealand all-rounder also hinted at the strategy his side may adopt against Bumrah. "The way the England boys played him yesterday was to try and take the overs as deep as possible," Phillips observed.

The logic is simple: keep wickets in hand until the closing stages so that if Bumrah misses his length even slightly, batters can capitalise.

Spurs on the brink

Tottenham lose again and face fight for EPL relegation

LONDON: Tottenham's Premier League survival hopes took another blow with a 3-1 loss to Crystal Palace.

Spurs — one of the richest teams in Europe and a founding member of the Premier League — are just one point above the relegation zone and without a domestic win in 2026.

"We know that the position we are in is not where we want to be. We need to figure out how to get out of it as soon as possible," said Tottenham striker Dominic Solanke on Thursday. "There have been difficulties, but we aren't in the position to make excuses. We

need to do the job on the pitch." Spurs' latest defeat was the fifth in a row and the third under new coach Igor Tudor, who was tasked with the responsibility of turning the season around.

He watched as his team capitulated in front of a home crowd at the Tottenham Hotspur Stadium — conceding three goals in the first half, having taken the lead and then gone down to 10 men when Micky van de Ven was sent off.

Palace took full advantage by scoring three times in seven minutes before the break. AGENCIES



Tottenham's players after the match

PA



Priyanka Chopra Jonas to present award at 98th Oscars

The awards ceremony will be held at the Dolby Theatre at Ovation Hollywood on March 15

Priyanka Chopra Jonas will take the stage as a presenter at the 98th Academy Awards, the organisers announced. The actress will be joined by fellow presenters Will Arnett, Robert Downey Jr., Anne Hathaway, Paul Mescal and Gwyneth Paltrow, said by executive producer and showrunner Raj Kapoor and executive producer Katy Mullan.

Previously announced presenters include Adrien Brody, Javier Bardem, Kieran Culkin, Chris Evans, Chase Infiniti, Mikey Madison, Demi Moore, Kumail Nanjiani, Maya Rudolph and Zoe Saldana. Organisers said further talent announcements would be made in the lead-up to the ceremony.

This isn't the first time Chopra Jonas has been part of the Oscars. The actress, along with husband Nick Jonas, announced the nominations for the 93rd Academy Awards in 2021.

Hosted by comedian Conan O'Brien, the 98th Oscars will be held at the Dolby Theatre at Ovation Hollywood. The ceremony will air live



She'll be joined by fellow presenters Will Arnett, Robert Downey Jr, Anne Hathaway, Paul Mescal and Gwyneth Paltrow

on 'ABC' and stream live on 'Hulu' on March 15.

Chopra Jonas was most recently seen in the film 'The Bluff', co-starring Karl Urban of 'The Boys' fame. Before that, she starred in 'Heads of State' alongside John Cena and Idris Elba.

Her earlier Hollywood credits include the Amazon spy thriller series 'Citadel', 'The Matrix Resurrections', 'Love Again' and ABC thriller series 'Quantico'. She is set to feature in the second season of 'Citadel' and will also appear in the comedy 'Judgment Day' alongside Will Ferrell and Zac Efron.

Peter Jackson to receive Palme d'Or at Cannes Film Festival

The film festival will take place on May 12

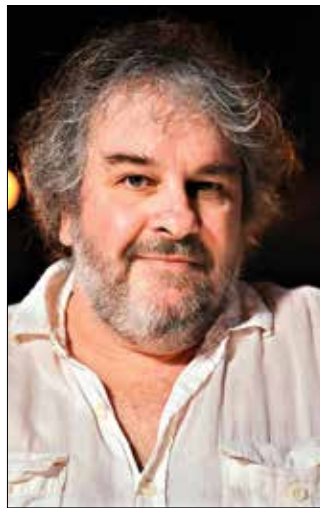
Filmmaker Peter Jackson, known for directing acclaimed projects such as 'The Lord of the Rings' and 'The Hobbit' trilogies, will be honoured with an honorary Palme d'Or at the Cannes Film Festival.

The filmmaker will be awarded for his 'body of work that blends Hollywood blockbusters and films d'auteur with extraordinary artistic vision and technological audacity', according to the festival's official website.

Jackson will be honoured at the opening ceremony of the 79th Cannes Film Festival, which will take place on May 12. The director said it is one of the greatest privileges of his career to be presented with the award.

"To be honoured with an Honorary Palme d'Or at Cannes is one of the greatest privileges of my career," he said.

He added, "Cannes has been a meaningful part of my filmmaking journey. In 1988, I attended the Festival Marketplace with my first movie, 'Bad Taste', then in 2001, we screened a preview sequence from 'The Fellowship of the Ring', both of which were important milestones in my career. This festival has always celebrated bold, visionary cinema and I'm incredibly



The director said it is one of the greatest privileges of his career to be presented with the award

grateful to the Festival de Cannes for being recognised among the filmmakers and the artists whose work continues to inspire me."

The festival will start on May 12 and conclude on May 23.

DIIVA DUTTA'S 'CHIRAIYA' REMINDS ONE OF BENGALI SERIES 'SAMPURNA'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

For those who have watched the Bengali web series 'Sampurna' on 'Hoichoi', you are bound to find a resemblance with the trailer of Divya Dutta-starrer Hindi web series 'Chiraiya'. Also, with 'Chiraiya', 'SVF Entertainment' steps into the Hindi-language digital series. This is the same company that owns 'Hoichoi', the Bengali digital platform. Therefore, the similarities are hard to ignore.

Much like Bengali actress Sohini Sarkar in 'Sampurna', Divya plays an ideal daughter-in-law of a close-knit family, whose seemingly stable world begins to shatter when she discovers that

The series also stars Sanjay Mishra, Siddharth Shaw, Prasanna Bisht, Faisal Rashid and others

her sister-in-law Pooja is facing sexual abuse within her marriage. As difficult truths begin to unfold, she finds herself torn between protecting her family's honour and standing up for what is right.

From the trailer, 'Chiraiya' seems to highlight the same issues that 'Sampurna' did. It's a social drama on marriage, consent and silence. In 'Sampurna', the issues



silences we've inherited. I've always been mindful of the characters I bring to life, but Kamlesh (her character) is different. She is a piece of my heart. She is a woman bound by the values she has always cherished, yet she finds herself at a crossroads where her love for her family meets her refusal to ignore injustice. I truly hope 'Chiraiya' makes us pause and rethink the 'norms' we've been conditioned to accept. It's time we start conversations that have been overdue for generations," said Divya.

of marital rape and its impact on mental health were highlighted too.

"With 'Chiraiya', we aren't just telling a story; we are holding up a mirror to the

The series also stars Sanjay Mishra, Siddharth Shaw, Prasanna Bisht, Faisal Rashid, Tinnu Anand, Sarita Joshi and Anjum Saxena and premieres on 'JioHotstar' on March 20.

'ASPIRANTS' SEASON 3 TRAILER

Collision of ambitions and power

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Prime Video' released the trailer of the third season of its widely celebrated Hindi drama series, 'Aspirants'. With Season 3, the story moves into a new phase where past ambitions intersect with present responsibility, as a rivalry born in Mukherjee Nagar resurfaces in positions of power. Created and produced by 'The Viral Fever', this season is directed by Deepesh Sumitra Jagdish and it stars Naveen Kasturia, Shivankit Singh Parihar, Abhilash Thapliyal, Sunny Hinduja, Namita Dubey and Tengam Celine in their repris-

To premiere on 'Prime Video' on March 13

ing roles, with Jatin Goswami joining the cast as the newest addition.

'Aspirants' Season 3 will premiere exclusively on 'Prime Video' on March 13.

"Aspirants' has always been incredibly special to me because audiences didn't just watch Abhilash; they grew up with him. In Season 3, we meet him at a point where the dream has come true on paper, but the ground reality is far more com-



at stake. This version of Abhilash is more vulnerable, more conflicted and a lot more honest about his flaws. I'm grateful that viewers continue to resonate with his story and I cannot wait for viewers to see where his journey goes next," shared Naveen Kasturia.

Sunny Hinduja added, "Season 3 explores what happens to friendships, ambitions and the ideals that once felt simple are now tested by power, distance and circumstance. This season, Sandeep bhaiya is dealing with his own evolution while watching the boys he once guided make decisions he may not always agree with."

plicated. He is juggling public expectations, personal guilt and the fear of letting down the people who believed in him most. For me, what made this chapter powerful was exploring how ambition feels when you already have everything

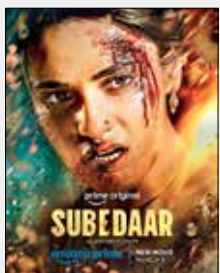
Radhikka talks about the vulnerable core of Shyama in 'Subedaar'

Madan co-stars with Anil Kapoor in the 'Prime Video' series

OUR CORRESPONDENT

If Subedaar Arjun Maurya is the Sher, his daughter Shyama is nothing short of a Sava Sher. In Prime Video's action drama 'Subedaar', Radhikka Madan steps into a character that matches the Subedaar's ferocity with a fire of her own. Fierce, volatile and emotionally layered, Shyama isn't just a presence in Arjun Maurya's world - she is a force that challenges it. Beneath the hardened exterior lies a woman shaped by survival, carrying wounds that run far deeper than they appear.

Recalling why

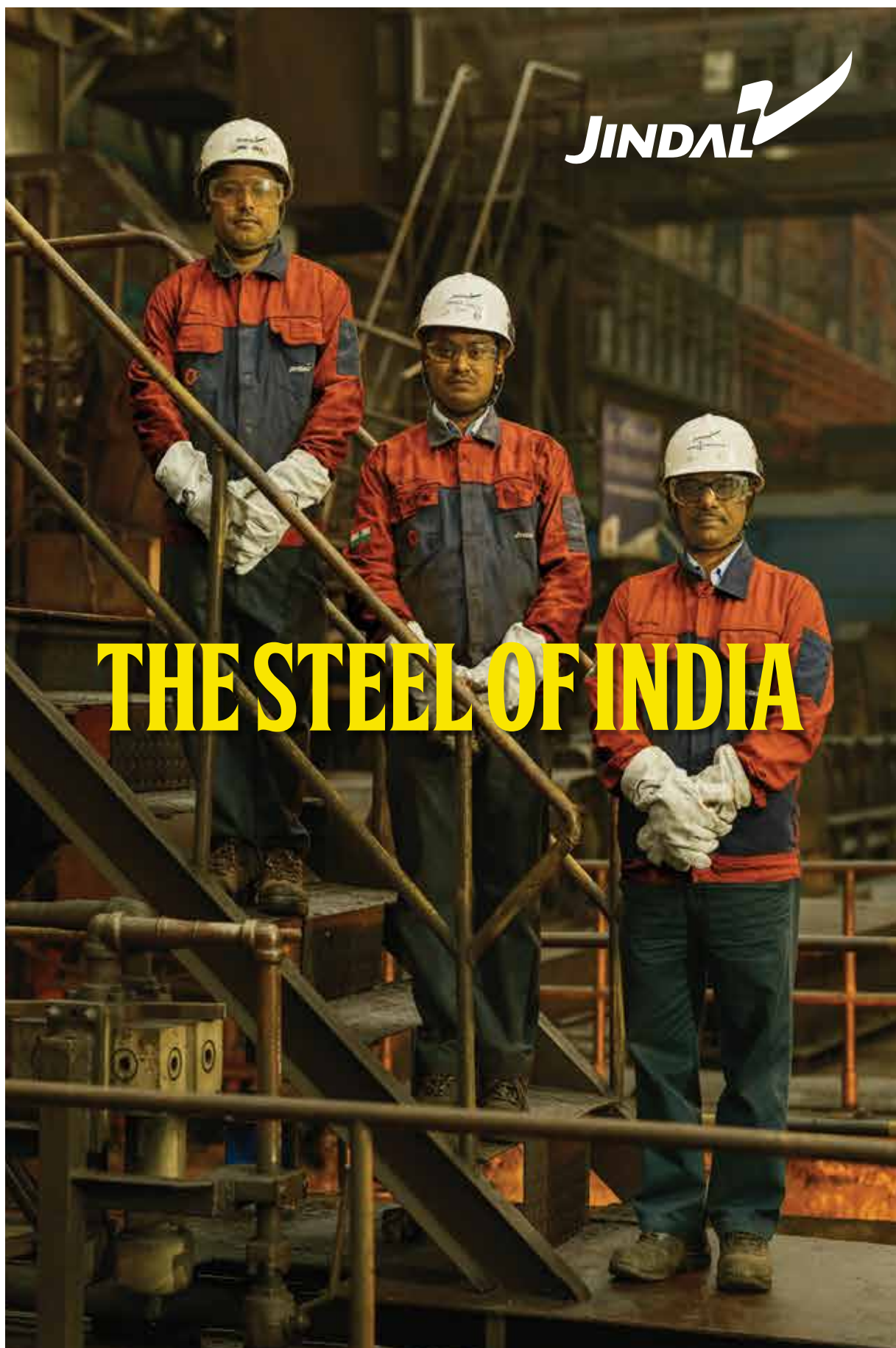


she agreed to the film during the narration itself, Radhikka Madan said, "This is the first film where I have said yes during narration. 'Subedaar' was one thing that was being offered to me for a long time. When Suresh Sir narrated it to me, in the narration only, I said yes. The way he (Suresh Triveni) narrated it, the soul of the story is something that really pulled me. People have offered me characters who are physically strong, where there is some action, this happens, that happens and the character looks very strong from the outside, but I think the core of Shyama is so vulnerable. She is so soft inside. That layer really excited me because she's so broken. Everything else is a facade."

Speaking about the vulnerability behind Shyama's strength, Radhikka shared, "Her strength is a facade. Her survival is a facade. There's a reason why she's not soft in the world because her survival instinct is really, really high. She doesn't feel safe anywhere. And she keeps running from things. So, I think those layers really excited me and made me say yes to the character."

Madan added, "She really wants to be like her mother. And she doesn't like her father, but she's actually her father."

'Her strength is a facade. Her survival is a façade,' says the actress



**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Tender Notice No.: IRTMTC/2025-26

Dated- 05.03.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Principal IRTMTC/North Central Railway, Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites online open tenders (E-tender) as detailed below :-

SN : 1 | Approx Cost (In Rs.) : Rs. 94.10274.00 | Earnest Money (In Rs.) : Rs. 188210.00

E-Tender Notice No.: IRTMTC/2025-26/01 GeM bid Number : GEM/2026/B/7320156 dated : 05.03.2026

Name of Work : Carrying out work of Housekeeping (cleaning & sanitation, carpentry, plumbing and Horticulture) work (activity and outcome based) of IRTMTC as per schedule of work and special terms And conditions.

Date & Time of Closing of tender : 30.03.2026 at 15:00

Completion of Period : 24 Months

Nature of work : Any work of Housekeeping or Cleaning.

SN : 2 | Approx Cost (In Rs.) : Rs. 1837070.00 | Earnest Money (In Rs.) : Rs. 36750.00

E-Tender Notice No.: IRTMTC/2025-26/02 GeM bid Number : GEM/2026/B/7321111 dated : 05.03.2026

Name of Work : Mechanized washing and ironing of misc linens and Dry washing of blankets of IRTMTC for 02 years.

Date & Time of Closing of tender : 30.03.2026 at 15:00

Completion of Period : 24 Months

Nature of work : Mechanized washing of linen for Indian Railway, Or Dry cleaning of blankets for Indian railways. Or Mechanized washing of linen for hotels which are minimum three star certified by ministry of Tourism Or Mechanized washing of linen for Hospitals having minimum 100 bed capacity, Or Mechanized washing of linen for Airlines service (Domestic/International)

Note : 1: For full details and submission of tenders, please see the Indian Railway website www.Gem.gov.in. 50726 (AS)

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

NORTHERN RAILWAY

e-OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Engineer-I/Northern Railway, New Delhi for and on behalf of President of India invites e-tender on the prescribed form for the under noted work.

Name of work with location, cost of work and Earnest money:
1. Augmentation of PNP Running Room by constructing an additional Building Comprising of 12 New Rooms in the Existing Running room in the section of SSE/W/PNP under ADEN/PNP.

2. Standardization of turnouts & maintenance of track infrastructure in various yard in the section of SSE/PWay/KUN under ADEN/KUN.

3. Standardization of turnouts & maintenance of track infrastructure in various yard in the section of SSE/PWay/PNP under ADEN/PNP.

4. Standardization of turnouts & maintenance of track infrastructure in various yard in the section of SSE/PWay/SNP under ADEN/PNP.

Approx. Cost : 1. Rs. 1,41,50,403.02/- 2. Rs. 1,14,91,506.69/-
3. Rs. 1,08,94,169.18/- 4. Rs. 1,19,82,082.14/-

Earnest Money : 1. Rs. 2,20,800/- 2. Rs. 2,07,500/-
3. Rs. 2,04,500/- 4. Rs. 2,09,900/-

Completion Period : 1. 12 Months 2,3 & 4. 09 Months

Earnest Money should be in the form of net banking or payment gateway only. Note : FDR or Demand Draft will not be accepted as EMD for tender invited on IREPS as per Railway Boards letter No. 2015/CE-I/CT/5/1 dated 31.08.2016.

Date and time of submission of tender and opening of tender: Upto 15.00 hrs. on 27.03.2026, opening of e-tender at 15.00 hrs. on 27.03.2026.

Website particulars, published-tender, notice location etc complete details of tender can be seen and website where the tender form can be downloaded: Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

Similar nature of work: 1. Construction of Building/Quarters.
2. Any type of Track work.

NOTE: All attachments must be self attested by the tenderers and the affidavit should be submitted in the new format attached with tender conditions as per Annexure-XXIV is compulsory.

No.: 128-W/280/Tender Notice/25-26/W-1(NIT-46-49) Dated: 05.03.2026 751/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

**Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited**
(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
(ISO 9001 : 2015 Certified)

1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No.1, Tebbandha, Raipur (C.G.) - 492006
CIN: 145202CT198180001851, PAN: AADKM288N, GST Regn No:22AADKM288N52Y
Phone: 0771-4621000 Fax: 0771-2587594
Website: www.csidc.in, Email address: csdc_cg@nic.in, csdc_raipur@yahoo.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (1st call)
(Through e-Procurement Portal Only)

No.: 36/CSIDC/E.E.-I/Division-I/2025-26/ Raipur, dated 05/03/2026

Online (Percentage Basis) tenders in Form-A are invited from contractors registered in Class-B & Above in New Unified Registration System (E-Registration) website <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> at appropriate class, for the following works:-

S.No.	Name of Work	Registered Contractor in CGPWD or in appropriate class in other dep't.	Time allowed including rainy season	Estimated Cost (INR Lacs)	EMD (INR Rs.)	Cost of Tender Doc. (INR including GST 18%)
1.	Repairing & Maintenance of Existing 24m & 18m wide BT roads at I/A Nayanpur-Girvarganj, Distt. Surajpur (C.G.)	B & Above	03 Months i/c rainy season	252.84 Lacs	1,50,000/-	3540/-

The tender document and other details can be downloaded from the web portal (website) <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> from **05.03.2026** and shall be submitted online only. Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

NOTE: 1) The interested tenderers for online submission of tender may contact CG eProc Helpdesk. Operated by Mjunction Services Limited., they may reach Helpdesk using 18002582502 (from 9 AM to 11 PM) (therein press 2 for CG-e-Proc) or you can email them at Helpdesk.eproc@cgswan.gov.in.
2) Tenderer may contact to E.E., Div-I, CSIDC, Udyog Bhawan in working hours to clear their doubt if any before online submission of the tender

samvad 47114/3

Executive Engineer, Division-I

GOVERNMENT OF WEST BENGAL
CORRIGENDUM NOTICE

Notice Inviting e-Tender No. 26/EE-SW/M/NKDA/2025-26

Name of Work : 1. Repair and Renovation Work, and Approach Road in Different Waste Transfer Station at Action Area- I, II & III under NKDA.

Last date of Online submission of Technical Bid and Financial Bid: 13.03.2026 upto 01:00 pm. (For Sl. No. 01) & For other details please visit our website at www.nkdamar.org & <https://wbntenders.gov.in> and the office notice board Newtown, Kolkata -700156.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
(Solid Waste Management)
New Town Kolkata Development Authority

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Raju Pasi @ Chapta S/o Ratan Pasi R/o Jhuggi No. C-108, G.P. Block, Pitampura, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **Ashu of FIR No. 364/2022 U/S 308/324/34 IPC, PS Maurya Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Raju Pasi @ Chapta** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Raju Pasi @ Chapta** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Raju Pasi @ Chapta of FIR No. 364/2022 U/S 308/324/34 IPC, PS Maurya Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **27.04.2026**

By Order,
Ms. Munesh Garg
Addl. Sessions Judge-03, (North-West)
Room No. 304, Third Floor
District Courts Rohini, Delhi

DP/2949/NW/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rajender, S/o.: Rakesh, R/o. H.No.106, Gali No. 04, Mandoli Extn., Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No. 683/2015 U/S 279/338 IPC** registered at **P.S Nand Nagri, North East District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said **Rajender** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Rajender** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rajender**, accused of **FIR No. 683/2015 U/S 279/338 IPC, P.S. Nand Nagri, North East District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.04.2026**.

By Order, Mrs. Deepakshi Rana,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No.19, First Floor, Shahdara District,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi.

DP/2863/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tendering Notice No. : 2026-Feb-05 dated : 03.03.2026

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N.C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:

Tender No. : 2026-Feb-05-01 | Approx Cost Rs. : 25316728.77

Description of work : Raising of 01 no platform to high level for recruitment of shortfall in Minimum Essential Amenities (MEA) at HAB in BHA-ETW section.

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website "www.ireps.gov.in". Tenders can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" up to 15:00 hrs. on 25.03.2026 495/26 (C)

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

**पावरग्रिड
POWERGRID**

1. The Petitioner above-named has filed a petition before the Central Electricity Regulatory Commission, New Delhi for determination of transmission tariff for 2024-29 tariff block for Petition-1: Transmission System Strengthening Scheme for Evacuation of Power from Solar Energy Zones in Rajasthan (8.1 GW) under Phase-I, Part-G1" in Northern Region).

2. The beneficiaries of the Transmission system are: (a) Ajmer Vidyut Vitran Nigam Ltd. (b) Jaipur Vidyut Vitran Nigam Ltd. (c) Jodhpur Vidyut Vitran Nigam Ltd. (d) Punjab State Electricity Corporation limited (e) Haryana Power Purchase Centre (f) Jammu & Kashmir Power Corporation Ltd. (g) Uttar Pradesh Power Corporation Ltd. (h) BSES Yamuna Power Ltd. (i) BSES Rajdhani Power Ltd. (j) Tata Power Delhi Distribution Ltd. (k) Chandigarh Electricity department (l) Uttaranchal Power Corporation Ltd. (m) North Central Railway (n) New Delhi Municipal council. (o) Himachal Pradesh State Electricity Board. (p) Central Transmission Utility of India Ltd. (q) HVPNL

Particulars	Asset-1
Scheduled date of commercial operation	30.09.2023
Actual date of commercial operation	30.11.2025
Capital cost on the date of commercial operation (in Rs Lakhs)	1108.67 Cr

3. Details of tariff for 2024-29 block:

	Asset	2024-25	2025-26	2026-27	2027-28	2028-29
Asset-1	0.00	3917.09	14337.47	15072.56	15445.33	

4. A copy of the petition made for determination of tariff is posted on the website www.powergrid.in

5. The suggestions and objections, if any, on the proposals for determination of tariff contained in the petition may be filed by any person, including the beneficiary through the e-filing portal of the Commission, with a copy to the Petitioner within 30 days of publication of this notice.

Place: Gurugram
Date: 07.03.2026

Zafrul Hasan
General Manager (Commercial)

POWER GRID CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise)

Registered Office: B-9, Qutab Institutional Area, Katwaria Sarai, New Delhi 110 016
Corporate Office: Saudamini, Plot No.2, Sector-29, Gurgaon, Haryana - 122 001
Website: www.powergrid.in, CIN: L40101DL1989G01038121

A Maharatna PSU

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-AUCTION NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS (<http://ireps.gov.in>) for the allotment of under mention contracts at following Railway stations/locations:

S. N.	E-Catalogue No.	Date & Time of Bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Lots
1.	Parking-06-2026	23.03.2026 at 11:00 Hrs	Parking cum Access Control Rights at Hazrat Nizamuddin Railway Station = Total 01 Site
2.	Parking-07-2026	24.03.2026 at 11:00 Hrs	Panipat (Car) (1 st Entry), Kurukshetra (2 nd Entry) (Cycle-Scooter), Murad Nagar,Rohtak (2 nd Entry), Bareta, Budhlada, Karnal (2 nd Entry) (Cycle-Scooter-Car), Meerut Cantt, Khekar (Circulating area), Sharni (Near PRS), Sampla (Main Entry), Sampla (2 nd Entry), Kurukshetra (1 st Entry) (Cycle - Scooter - Car), Thanesar, Rohtak (1 st Entry), Sonipat (1 st Entry), Sonipat (2 nd Entry) = Total 17 Sites

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen,

<https://ireps.gov.in/>

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfill following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:

1. Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module-Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module
2. Payment of One Time Registration Fee
3. Current Account in State Bank of India.
4. Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account.
5. Lien Marking of Funds.
6. Updation of Turnover Details.
7. Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender/E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query

Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi - 110055; Email: pkg.deldivdivision@gmail.com, Tel: 011-23743084

No.: 23AC/393/E-Auction/PKG/2026 Dated: 06.03.2026 764/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Nirmal Kumar, S/o: Mukesh Kumar, R/o: H.No-J-177, GN 10, 4th, Pusta Kartar Nagar, Usman Pur Delhi** also at **R/o: H.No-B-325, Street No-2, North Ghonda, Delhi-110053** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 02119/2021, U/s: 379/411 IPC, P.S. Burari, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Nirmal Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Nirmal Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Nirmal Kumar of P.S. Burari, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **23.04.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Payal Singal
JMFC-09, Central Distt., Room No. 286,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/2825/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely: **Lucky Lal Shagal, S/o. Vijay Kumar Shagal, R/o.: S.L. Sharma, D-88, Ground Floor, Chander Vihar, Abchal Nagar, Nihal Vihar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.424/2016 U/S 33/38/52/58 Delhi Excise Act** registered at **P.S Ranhola, Outer District, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Lucky Lal Shagal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Lucky Lal Shagal** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Lucky Lal Shagal**, accused of **FIR No. 424/2016 U/S 33/38/52/58 Delhi Excise Act, P.S Ranhola, Outer District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.05.2026**.

By Order, ANKIT KARAN SINGH
Judicial Magistrate First Class-08 (West)
Room No.30, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/2783/OD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Rahul Parcha S/o Shyam Kumar R/o H. No. 21/336 Trilokpur Mayur Vihar Phase-I, New Delhi Also At: 21/340 Trilokpur Mayur Vihar Phase-I New Delhi Also At: H. No. 181, Abhay Khand-I Indrapuram, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 130/2018 U/S392/473/482/427/411/34 IPC & 25 A. Act PS: Lajpat Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rahul Parcha** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rahul Parcha** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rahul Parcha** accused of **FIR No. 130/2018 U/S392/473/482/427/411/34 IPC & 25 A. Act PS: Lajpat Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.04.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Shivani Chauhan
DP/2907/SE/2026 ASJ, Room No. 613 (Fast Track Court)-1,
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/2907/SE/2026 ASJ, Room No. 613 (Fast Track Court)-1, (Court Matter)

BSES

BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, New Delhi

TENDER NOTICE

Date: 07.03.2026

Sealed tenders under two parts (Un priced & priced) are invite for the supply of following materials from all bidders:-

NIT No.	Brief Item Description	Estimated Cost (₹)	Cost of EMD (₹)	Due Date & Time of Submission	Date & Time of Opening
CMC/BR/26-27/FK/CR/KB/1342	HIRING OF BHARAT BILL PAYMENT OPERATING UNITS (BBPOUS) FOR COLLECTION OF ELECTRICITY BILL PAYMENTS FOR BSES RAJDHANI POWER LIMITED	4.40 Crores	8 Lakhs	27.03.2026 15:00 HRS	27.03.2026 15:30 HRS

Cost of each Tender Document: ₹ 1180/-
For details in respect of Equipment/BOM/Services, Qualifying requirements, Terms & conditions, purchase/submission of tender documents etc. please visit our website www.bsesdelhi.com Head (Contracts & Materials)

Regd. Off.: BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, BSES Bhawan, Nehru Place, New Delhi-110019 | Corporate Identification No.: U40109DL2001PLC111527
Telephone No. : +91 11 4910 7235 | Website : www.bsesdelhi.com

**ICICI Bank**

Branch office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Vivek Chauhan / Sheela Chauhan/ LBDEL00004222711/ LBDEL00004222054/ LBDEL00005882116/ LBDEL00004222055/ LBDEL00004222051	Property Bearing No 24 Entire Third Floor With Terrace Block P, South Extn. Part II Delhi 110049/ March 03, 2026	October 15, 2025 Rs. 1,75,96,737.19/-	Delhi Ncr/ Bhubaneswar

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: March 07, 2026
Place: Delhi & Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

**GOVT. OF MAHARASHTRA**
Public Works (East) Division, Pune - 411 001
Phone No. 020/26122457

Web- www.mahapwd.gov.in & e-mail- east-pune.ceo@mahapwd.gov.in

E-TENDER NOTICE No. 146 For 2025-2026

The Executive Engineer, Public Works (East) Division, Pune - 411 001 invites bids for following work from Registered as well as unregistered Contractor, and full filling the qualifying criteria for B-2 Tender Format as per Maharashtra Government. Public Work Department G.R. No. CAT/2017/Pra.Kra-08/Bldg-2, dt. 27/9/2018 and Public Work Department Maralaya Mumbai Circular No. CAT/2017/Pra.Kra-08/Bldg-2, dt. 22/10/2018. Bids document can be downloaded from website <https://mahatenders.gov.in> Executive Engineer reserves all rights to accept or reject bids. Conditional bids will not be accepted.

NAME OF WORK AND ESTIMATE COST LIST

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost Rs.	Estimated Cost Rs. (In Words)	Earnest Money Deposit	Cost of e-tender Form Fee	Class of Contractor
1	Construction of District Sports Complex at Katphal, Tal - Baramati, Dist. Pune (Phase -2)	\$8,93,01,200/-	Rupees Fifty Eight Crore Ninety Three Lakh One Thousand Two Hundred Only	29,47,000/-	Rs.3540/- (With GST 18%)	Registered as well as unregistered Contractor

E-tender- Time Table

1	Period of Downloading of bid documents/ Sale start and end dates	Dt. 09.03.2026 @ 10.00 hrs. to Dt. 23.03.2026 @ 18.00 hrs.
2	Pre-bid Meeting in the Office of Chief Engineer, P. W. Region Office, Pune, Old Central Building, Pune-411001.	Dt. 11.03.2026 @ 12.00 hrs.
3	Period of Bid Submission/ Bid Submission Start and End date.	Dt. 09.03.2026 @ 10.00 hrs. to Dt. 23.03.2026 @ 18.00 hrs.
4	Bid Opening Period	Dt. 24.03.2026 @ 18.00 hrs. (If Possible) (In the office of Superintending Engineer, P.W. Circle, Pune.)

Note :- 1. All eligible/interested contractors are downloading and mandated to get enrolled on e-tendering portal - <https://mahatenders.gov.in>.
2. For online Payment related issues, kindly send email with Bank Reference Number to this email to merchand@mahapwd.in. You may also contact 022-27560149 for clarifications.
3. Other term and condition displayed in online e-tender forms. Right to reject any or all online bid of work without assigning any reasons thereof is reserved.
4. Above only Tender Notice is displayed on P.W.D. website "www.mahapwd.gov.in"
5. Online Bank Tender Downloading fee and Earnest money shall be paid via online using NEFT/RTGS or payment gateway mode.

Executive Engineer,
Public Work (East) Division,
Pune 411 001.

DGIPR/2026/27/6375

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Deepak Kumar, S/o: Kishore Kumar, R/o: E-59/A-372, Kalamder Colony, Dilshad Garden, Shahdara, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 503/2020 U/s 279/337/338 IPC, P.S.: Nand Nagri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Deepak Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Deepak Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Deepak Kumar** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 503/2020 U/s 279/337/338 IPC, P.S.: Nand Nagri, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.04.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 19
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/2861/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

The Dy. Chief Engineer/Construction/Northern Railway/Tilak Bridge/New Delhi, for and on behalf of the President of India invites e-tender under One Packet System for the under noted work:-

Full Name of Work	Maintenance of staff quarters in Railway colonies at Wazirpur, Shakti Nagar, Tughlakabad, Punjabi Bagh, Delhi Cantt & Rohtak. Office and Store of SSE/C/PWay/DEE & DSA, Office Complex of Dy. CE/C/TKJ, Dy. CE/C/S&C/TKJ, CEE/C/TKJ, Dy. CSTE/C/TKJ, XEN/C/ROK, Officer's Rest House at Lohian Bridge and other assets under Dy. CE/C/TKJ.	
2	Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 178.85 Lacs
3	Completion period of the work	12 Months
4	Earnest Money to be deposited	Rs. 2,39,400.00
5	Sale/availability of tender document on Railway Website	Tender documents will be available on IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in from 06.03.2026 to 27.03.2026 upto 15:00 hrs.
6	Last date/Time of upload of tenders	27.03.2026 upto 15:00 hours. Tender documents can be uploaded by the tenderer on IREPS website w.e.f. 13.03.2026 to 27.03.2026.
7	Date and time of opening of tender	27.03.2026 at 11:30 hours (immediately after close of uploading of tender (D2)). The detailed tender notice also can be seen on the Notice Board of the above office.

Tender Notice No.: 495-ACS-C-Maintenance-TKJ Dated: 03.03.2026 753/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ranjeeta @ Rajjo, W/o: Lt. Vinod, R/o: Flat No. 52, Pocket-4, Sector-2, Rohini, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 29/2016 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S.: Farsh Bazar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ranjeeta @ Rajjo** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ranjeeta @ Rajjo** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ranjeeta @ Rajjo** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 29/2016 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S.: Farsh Bazar, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.04.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Akhil Malik
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
Room No. 38, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/2604/SHD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Lucky Soni S/o Ram Tirath R/o C-39, Street No. 13, West Karawal Nagar, Delhi and Navasta, Galla Mandi, Sainik Chauraha, Manpur, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 264/2023 U/s 379/356/411/34 IPC Act, PS Karawal Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Lucky Soni** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Lucky Soni** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Lucky Soni** of Case **FIR No. 264/2023 U/s 379/356/411/34 IPC Act, PS Karawal Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **21.04.2026**

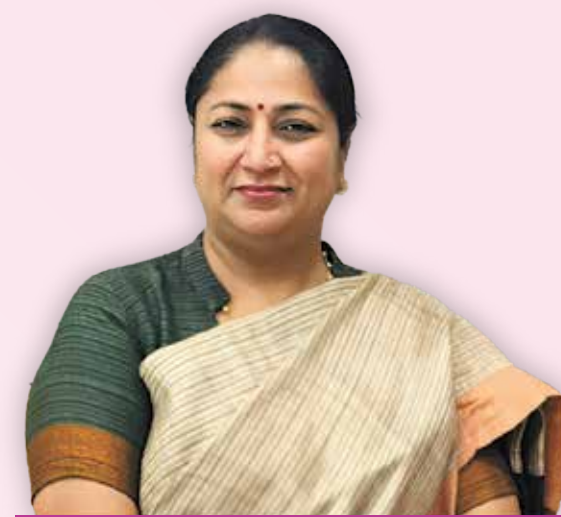
By Order
Isra Jaidi
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
Room No. 64, 4th Floor, North-East Distt,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/2852/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused Namely: **Lina Nizanin, W/o.: Husain Mohd., R/o.: H.No.K/26-B, 2nd Floor, Kalkaji, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.345/2018 Dt.21/12/2018 U/S 454/380/341 IPC** registered at **P.S Hazrat Nizamuddin, South East District, New Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon

सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार

दिल्ली को बड़ा उपहार

प्रधानमंत्री जी
का आभार₹18,000 करोड़+
का कनेक्टिविटी बूस्ट

माननीय प्रधानमंत्री

श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी जी द्वारा

दिल्ली मेट्रो फेज-IV के 2 नए कॉरिडोर का
शुभारंभ

- मजलिस पार्क - मौजपुर बाबरपुर (पिंक लाइन)
- दीपाली चौक - मजलिस पार्क (मैजेंटा लाइन)

मेट्रो फेज-V (A) के 3 नए कॉरिडोर का
शिलान्यास

- आर.के. आश्रम मार्ग - इंद्रप्रस्थ (सेंट्रल विस्टा कॉरिडोर)
- एरोसिटी - IGI टर्मिनल-1
- तुगलकाबाद - कालिंदी कुंज

08 मार्च 2026 | सुबह 10:00 बजे

स्थान: डीडीए ग्राउंड, बुराड़ी रोड, संत निरंकारी मंडल के पास, नई दिल्ली

गरिमामयी उपस्थिति

श्री मनोहर लाल खट्टर

माननीय केंद्रीय आवासन एवं शहरी कार्य और विद्युत मंत्री

श्रीमती रेखा गुप्ता

माननीय मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

श्री हर्ष मल्होत्रा

माननीय केंद्रीय राज्य मंत्री
(सड़क, परिवहन और राजमार्ग तथा कॉरपोरेट कार्य)

श्री तोखन साहू

माननीय केंद्रीय आवासन एवं शहरी कार्य
राज्यमंत्री

डॉ. पंकज कुमार सिंह

माननीय स्वास्थ्य एवं परिवार कल्याण, परिवहन एवं
सूचना प्रौद्योगिकी मंत्री, दिल्ली सरकार